SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026
Thirtieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:
Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 26 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm
Tuesday 27 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 28 Oct	Liturgy of Word with Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 29 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 30 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	Mass, 7.30pm
Saturday 31 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm: Induction Mass of Fr Chris McDermott
Sunday 1 Nov: All Saints Day	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am: *Additional Mass for All Saints Day* Drumnabey,12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am: *Month's Mind, Brendan Cassidy*

ST PATRICK'S, DRUMQUIN – Fr Chris McDermott will be formally inducted as Parish Priest of Langfield (Drumquin) next Saturday evening, 31 October, by Bishop Michael Router, at an Installation Ceremony at the 5.00pm Vigil Mass in St Patrick's Church.
In looking forward to welcoming Fr Chris to Drumquin, we also welcome Bishop Router to the parish for the first time. There will be tea in the hall for everyone afterwards and a chance to meet the new Parish Priest and the new Bishop!

Fr Chris' induction as Parish Priest of Aghyaran is scheduled to take place at the 7.30pm Vigil Mass on Saturday 7 November and then in Ardstraw West & Castlederg at the 11.00am Mass in Castlederg on Sunday 22 November. Further details next week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,262 & €11.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,756 & €74, made up of:
Castlederg £938 & €59, **Drumnabey** £557 & €15, **Dregish** £261. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,078.
Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In September these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £881 & €20 CRF £692; **Ardstraw West Castlederg:** £2,394; **Drumquin:** £2,245.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The October draw will take place after Mass in Dregish today.

SVP Meeting takes place this Wednesday, 28 October, in the Parochial House, Drumquin, at 7.30pm.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Rosemary Donnell, late of 10 Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg, whose Funeral Mass took place in Strabane on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Rosemary's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

PLEASE NOTE the following dates for November Masses remembering those who have died in the past year.
A candle in remembrance of each of those who have died will be lit:

CASTLEDERG: Monday 2 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Joe Gallagher, Pat Carolan, James Murray, Delma MvGlynn, Ellen Sweeney, Tom McHugh, Derek Duggan, Pat Keenan, Marrie McMenamin, Ann T. Doherty, Angela Laird, Doris Gallagher, Colleen Vukusic (nee Masterson), Brendan Douglas, Charlie Logue, Christine Clarke, Michael Harper, Evelyn Baxter, Molly Carlin.

AGHYARAN: Friday 6 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Noel Doherty, Ellen Lynch, Peter Moss, Madge McNamee, Danny Gallen, Danny O'Donnell, Don Browne.

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 7 November, 5.00pm, remembering: Mickey McLaughlin, Margaret McLaughlin, Tommy Kearney, Margaret McLaughlin, Cameron Donnelly, Paddy Gallagher, Fiona Scott, Joe Campbell, Gerry O'Kane, Frankie Breen, Brendan Cassidy.

DREGISH: Sunday 8 November, 9.30am, remembering Kay Nugent.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 8 November, 12.30pm, remembering: Hannah Devine, Terry Logue, Brendan (Bo) Lennon.

Families who have been bereaved in the past year are asked to check that the name of their loved one has been included above. If you have any query, please contact the Parish Office.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Sat 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments served.

BEGINNERS' UPHOLSTERY CLASS in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, Thursday 5 November, 6.30pm to 9.00pm. Cost £10 and booking is essential. All materials supplied. For information or to book, contact Claire on 07818091136.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dregish History Group invite you to a Book Launch in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Fri 13 Nov, at 7.30pm; refreshments will be served. The Group has produced two books, available at the event for purchase. One contains a selection of interesting local history articles by members of the Dregish History Group called ***'Gathering Hidden Gems on the History of Dregish and the People Together'.*** The second is a history of the ***Clergy of Adrstraw West*** by Brian Devenney, edited by Fr McCawille. Thank you to NLH Fund and Rapid for their support.

THANK YOU: Deborah Lowry offers her thanks to all who supported in any way the ***Team Hope Garden Tea Party*** at her home in September. She is most appreciative of the generosity shown by the entire community and is delighted to share that the event raised almost £5,000. The funds raised will support Team Hope's longer-term development work, helping vulnerable families and communities overseas to build more secure and hopeful futures.

TEAM HOPE CHRISTMAS SHOE-BOX APPEAL for children in Africa and Eastern Europe: You are invited to fill a wrapped shoebox with gifts using the 4Ws - something to Write, Wash, Wear and Wow, and include a €6 contribution towards transport and delivery. Shoeboxes can be dropped off between 1 and 10 Nov at Castle Coffee, or Urban Barn/Pet Store, both in Castlederg. For further details, labels and guidance, visit www.teamhope.ie. Thank you, from Deborah Lowry and all at Team Hope!

As our parishes prepare to welcome Fr Chris next weekend, Fr Thomas and I take this opportunity to wish him every blessing in his ministry in Aghyaran, Ardstraw West & Castlederg and Drumquin.

Born in 1986, Fr Chris is a native of Leckpatrick Parish. His parents, Rosemary and Sean, live in Strabane. Fr Chris tells us that his three brothers, two nieces and a nephew form his closest family. Following school, Chris was employed for several years in an administrative role at the Oncology Department of Altnagelvin Hospital. He subsequently pursued seminary studies at St Malachy's College, Belfast, and St Patrick's College, Maynooth. Since ordination in June 2016, Fr Chris has ministered among the faith communities of St Eugene's Cathedral in Derry, Drumragh (Omagh), Limavady, Kilrea & Desertoghill, Errigal (Garvagh) and Granaghan (Swatragh).

Fr Chris says that, after spending the last five years 'on the missions' in Co Derry, he now looks forward to serving the people of the West Tyrone Pastoral Area. He and Kobe (the pet dog) will take up residence in Castlederg Parochial House at the end of the month.

Fr Chris brings many gifts to his ministry and, in giving generously of himself to serving the people entrusted to his care, I know that he will enjoy the support and encouragement of you all. I pray God's blessing on all that you will share and accomplish together.

Please keep Fr Chris in your prayers as he prepares to move to Castlederg and begin the next chapter of his priestly ministry in the West Tyrone Pastoral Area.

May God bless you all,

Fr Paul.

ARDMORE PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

ARDMORE PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES 25_OCTOBER_2026

No. 52 ~ THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF
31 Sixtowns Road
Telephone: 79628376
Email:ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 79632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street
Phone: (028)79628248
Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught
Phone: (028)79397047
Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:
Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org
Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
  - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
  - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
  - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.
www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.



NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm - DDS Mass

St Patrick's, Keenaught: **5.00 pm - NB Earlier Time**

SUNDAY MASSES

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 26 October

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Tuesday ~ 27 October

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm - DDS Mass.

Wednesday ~ 28 October

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Thursday ~ 29 October

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

1.00 pm ~ Ballinascreen Fold Mass

Friday ~ 30 October

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass.

Desertmartin: Keenaught, Saturday 6.30 pm until 7.10 pm.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Tuesday 27 October: St Otteran, monk.

Wednesday 28 October: Ss Simon and Jude.

Thursday 29 October: St Colman, bishop.

Saturday 31 October: Bl. Dominic Collins, martyr.

BALLINASCREEN FOLD

The FOLD Mass takes place on Thursday 29 October at 1.00 pm. All welcome.

D.D.S MASS

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20.

The following masses will be offered for the deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society:

Tuesday 27 October at 10.00 am in St Mary's, Coolcalm;

Saturday 31 October at 6.00 pm in Holy Rosary.

HALLOWEEN WEEKEND MASSES AND ALL SOULS DAY

In order to accommodate families and the celebration of Halloween next Saturday October 31, Mass in Keenaught will be celebrated at 5.00 pm and not 7.30 pm. Mass in Holy Rosary will be at the usual time of 6.00 pm.

Please note the change of Mass times for Monday 2 November - All Souls Day:

7.00 am ~ Holy Rosary.
10.00 am ~ Coolcalm & Moneyneena.
11.00 am ~ Sixtowns.
7.30 pm ~ Straw.
7.30 pm ~ Keenaught.

ROME & ASSISI PILGRIMAGE

During their pilgrimage to Assisi and Rome pilgrims from Ballinascreen and Desermtartin, accompanied by Fr Madden will pray for all parishioners and Mass will be offered by Fr Madden on Sunday (Today) at the Tomb of St Carlo Acutis for the intentions of all.

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of:
Terry Hegarty, Ranaghan Road.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

The Month's Mind Mass for Cecilia Bradley, Gortnari will be held on Friday 30 October at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for John Joe Shaw, Grange Lane, will be held on Friday 6 November at 10.00 am in St Mary's Church, Coolcalm.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:
First Anniversaries:
Kevin Kelly, Bancran;
John Joe McKenna, Cloane.
Anniversaries:
Maureen McCullagh, Belfast;
Brigid McEldowney, Fivemilestraight;
Reece Kelly, Mallon Villas;
Daniel Doherty, Cloane Rd.;
Alice kelly, Magherafelt Rd.
Desertmartin:
Selina McElwee;
Ignatius Crawley;
Alphonsus Crawley,
Geraldine Hughes;
Francis Loane;
Alphonsus Shaw;
Henry McBride;
Baby Mary McBride;
James Connery.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Callie Sophia Flanaghan, Glenshane Park.

PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES WITH BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER

The Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes led by **Bishop Michael Router** will take place in **July 2027.** There are **TWO** possible travel arrangements available to all pilgrims. A group will depart from **City of Derry Airport on Thursday 8 July 2027 and return to City of Derry Airport on Tuesday 13 July 2027.** A second group will depart from **Belfast Airport on Wednesday 7 July and return to Belfast Airport on Wednesday 14 July.** Any pilgrim interested in going should leave their name, contact details and flight preference with either **Fr Michael McCaul, Fr Peter Madden or in the Parish Offices** as soon as possible. Please note that the pilgrimage last year was **sold out** in 10 days.

ANNUAL SOLEMN NOVENA

In honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00 pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. *'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'*. Each night will comprise of the

Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us.

ST COLUMBA'S HARVEST THANKSGIVING

Rev. Canon Gary Millar and St Columba's Church of Ireland congregation extend a warm welcome to our Harvest Thanksgiving at 7.00 pm on Sunday 26 October. Our guest choir is Tamlaght O'Crilly Community Choir and the evening will conclude with an apple tart supper.

VIATORES CHRISTI PARISH VISIT

Members of Viatores Christi will speak at Masses in this parish during the Saturday Vigil and the Sunday Masses on the Weekend of 7/8 November. Viatores Christi (VC), is an association of Catholic lay missionary/development workers, founded in 1960 .VC brings about positive change by improving access to healthcare, education and livelihood opportunities in the marginalised communities in which we work. We want to raise awareness about the missionary work of the Church and the role of lay missionaries, both at home and overseas. Thank the people of the Derry Diocese for your support for our work over the years. We would like to offer an opportunity and preparation to anyone who feels called to volunteer. And we appeal for ongoing help both financially and above all through prayer. There will be an exit collection in aid of the work of VC.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £1341

Renovation Collection - £811

Mission Collection - £1390

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1329.10

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

Fully escorted group to Fatima accompanied by Spiritual Director, 28 June – 5 July 2027. Direct Daytime Flights Belfast to Porto return. Staying in 4* Hotel. Full Board. Services of JWT Pilgrimage Guide. Daily Mass & Spiritual Activities. Cost £975pps. Early Booking Offer: £100 OFF if Paid In Full by 30 November 2026. Further details contact Christina Lagan 07803192621

CHOIR DIRECTOR: ST EUGENE'S CATHEDRAL, DERRY

10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack - Tel.: (028) 7126 2302 or Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or Email to: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications to be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026.

DERRY DIOCESE VOCATIONS

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan - Email: pgoh2111@gmail.com or Tel.: (028) 79386259.

CASTOR LIFE / O'KANE'S PHARMACY

O'Kane's Pharmacy event in collaboration with Castor Life, exploring the potential benefits of incorporating castor oil into everyday health and wellness routines. The event will be led by Castor Life founders, Jacqui and Claudio, who have a wealth of knowledge and experience in the use of castor oil. They'll be discussing its traditional uses and potential benefits, including skincare, joint and muscle comfort, scalp health and digestive wellness. Thursday 29 October in The Hub, Draperstown from 7.00 pm to 9.00 pm Tickets: £5 (redeemable on the night & available to buy in our Tobermore Road Pharmacy).

COMMUNITY WREATH MAKING WORKSHOP

Nominate 2 - 5 people to take part, this could be committee members, or a group of parents / supporters producing a wreath for their children's local school, sports club etc. or a group of friends that attend activities / workshops delivered by the organisation. Monday 26 October, 2 & 9 November from 6.30 pm to 8.30 pm in Workspace Community Hub, 50 High Street, Draperstown. To register your group to take part please contact Rosemary, Email: info@cfballinascreen.org or Tel.:07748 645007

WARM WELCOME WEDNESDAY

Workspace Community Hub - Wednesday 28 October from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. We will be joined by PRONI, the Public Record Office of Northern Ireland at 11.45am. PRONI's role is to identify, preserve and enhance access to records of historical, social and cultural significance. We will learn about PRONI's history, the material it holds, started with online research and how to make a visit. Also discussed, how their collections can be used to trace family tree or local history research. Just drop in on the day. Free tea, coffee & refreshments.

KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Craft Fair: Sunday 8 November from 10:30 am to 3.00 pm. Santa will visit from 11.00 am to 2.00 pm! A wonderful selection of handmade treasures from talented crafters from all over Mid-Ulster! Over 25 stalls packed with handmade goodies! festive decorations and so much more — there's something for everyone! Support local crafters, find unique Christmas presents and enjoy a lovely festive day out! Bring the children along to meet Santa and get into the Christmas spirit! Spread the word and bring your family and friends — we look forward to seeing you there!

SARSFIELD'S ACCORDION BAND.

Band practice on Thursday evenings 7:30pm. New and past members are welcome to come along.

SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP

Join us at Sixtowns Cross Community Hall for Halloween this year.

Children's Fancy Dress Halloween Disco (Pre & Primary School): Thursday 29 October from 6.30 pm to 8.30 pm. Entry £3, or £10 per family. Tuck shop, music and prizes. All children to be accompanied by an adult.

Adults' Halloween Disco: Saturday 31 October from 8.30 pm to midnight. Entry £10, food included. Live DJ, raffle on the night. Prizes for best dressed.

Indoor Bowls: Mondays at 8.15 pm. New Members Welcome.

Christmas Fair with Santa: Sunday 29 November 2026 at Sixtowns Hall. Tables are booking up fast. £20 per table or £30 for two. To book Tel.: 07769 289385

GAELSCOIL & NAÍSCOIL NA SPEIRÍNÍ - OPEN AFTERNOON

Sunday 15 November from 1.00 pm to 3.00 pm. Parents and children who are ready for Primary 1 and Nursery in September 2027 are very welcome to visit the school and meet with staff and pupils. Fun Activities for all. Santa Claus will be there to meet all the children too.

BINGO FOR BALI

Join us for an evening of fun bingo, laughter and great prizes as we raise funds for occupational therapy equipment for underprivileged children in Bali. Saturday 14 November in An Ráth Dubh, Moneyneany. Doors open at 7.00 pm, eyes down at 7:30 pm. Tickets £15, available at Centra, Draperstown; Heron's Chemist; or Spar, Tobermore. Or contact Katie at 07834276636 or Amy on 07517079916. All support greatly appreciated!

ANNIVERSARY CONGRATULATIONS

Congratulations to Angela & Gerard McGuigan, Knocknagin Road, who recently celebrated sixty-seven years of enduring love and commitment.

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

1 November, St. Columba's, Straw.
8 November, St Eugene's Moneyneena.
29 November, Holy Rosary Church.
6 December, St. Patrick's, Sixtowns.
13 December, St. Columba's, Straw.
20 December, St Eugene's Moneyneena.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

November 8 & 22 2026
December 6 & 20 2026
January 10 & 24 2027
February 7 & 21 2027
March 7 & 14 2027
April 4 & 18 2027

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Buncrana Parish Newsletter ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week's collection for Mission Sunday totalled €6,135
Sincere thanks.

Anniversary Masses & Times

ST MARY'S ORATORY
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana
Monday 26 Oct - Mass at 10am
Thanksgiving Mass
Tuesday 27 Oct - Mass at 10am
Daniel McLaughlin
Wednesday 28 Oct - Mass at 10am
John Doherty, recently deceased
Thursday 29 Oct - Mass at 10am
Special Intention
Saturday 31 Oct - Mass at 4:30pm
Mary Doherty (MM),
Betty Feeney (5th A)
Charlie and Barbara McLaughlin (Hawker)
Sunday 1 Nov - Mass at 8:30am
Sunday 1 Nov - Mass at 12:30pm
Rachel Doherty (Stout) (18th A)

ST. MARY'S, COCKHILL
Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill
Friday 30 Oct - Mass at 7pm
Jeanette Morrison (MM),
Pat Doherty, plus
Maeve McLaughlin (11th A)
Sunday 1 Nov - Mass at 11am
Seamus Hutchinson

STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY
Masses streamed on
www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish
Sunday 1 Nov - Mass at 9:45am

DEATHS
Your prayers are asked for
Joseph Doherty (Richard)
James Ferns
Noel Doherty (Greyhound)
Josh O'Hagan
who have died recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS
St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

VOCATIONS MEETING
There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (048) 79386259.

NEW ALTAR SERVERS
We are again recruiting new altar servers so any pupil currently in 3rd Class or older, and who have made their First Holy Communion are welcome to apply. Application forms can be obtained from schools.

Priest on Call 074 9361253

Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com
Website: www.buncranaparish.com
Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time
25 October 2026

THROWING OPEN THE DOORS TO CHRIST NOVENA
Our Annual Novena begins this Sunday 25 October at 7pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill.
For the nine Sundays before Christmas we will gather for one hour and the ceremony will comprise of the Rosary, a talk given by an invited speaker, the Novena prayer and petitions (which can be placed in a box at the door of the church), a Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and finishing with Benediction of the Most Blessed Sacrament.
Once again, the theme of this year's Novena is "Throwing Open the Doors to Christ" – taken from the homily of Pope St John Paul II at the Opening Mass of his Pontificate on 22 October 1978.
The first Guest speaker on the opening night will be **Bishop Michael Router.** All are very welcome. Please come along, bring your families and make the most of this opportunity for prayer as we approach the season of Christ's birth.
(The Holy Hour each Sunday evening in St Mary's Oratory will cease for the moment, resuming after Christmas.)

"NOVEMBER REMEMBER" PASTORAL INITIATIVE
With the grim statistic of there having been 150 people killed on the country's roads so far this year (12 more than the same period last year) – 45 of these people aged under 25 and 30 aged over 65 (of the 29 pedestrians killed, 10 were over 65) – we need to redouble our efforts as road users to do what we can to make our roads safer, especially as we enter the darker and colder months.
To this end, while November is a time when we remember our dead, this year, in an attempt to acknowledge that the life and death of each of us has its influence on others, we would like as many people as possible to take on a pledge to use the roads with care in November. The details of that pledge are to be found on posters and our social media pages. Also, next weekend, people are asked to collect a prayer card for their car to be recited each day during the month and a bottle of holy water to be sprinkled on their car and kept there.
Chief Superintendent Goretti Sheridan will address the Cockhill Novena on Sunday 1 November and launch this initiative. There will be signage placed on the roads entering our two parishes to remind us of this. Please do your best to participate in this and support it.
Father Bradley

ALL SAINTS AND ALL SOULS
MASS TIMES
Saturday 31 October (Vigil Mass)
4:30pm in St Mary's Oratory

Sunday 1 November (All Saints)
Usual Sunday Mass Times

Monday 2 November (All Souls)
10am St Mary's Oratory (Confessions from 9.30am)
7pm St Mary's, Cockhill (Confessions from 6.30pm)
8pm Star of the Sea (Confessions from 7.30pm)

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary's Oratory and St Mary's Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary's Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary's Cockhill.

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Walsh 9361393
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9361253
Parish Catechist 086 785 3726

ADORATION CHAPEL
Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel
Sunday 2pm - 10pm
Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm
Friday 6am - 10pm
ADORERS NEEDED
There are many hours in the Adoration Chapel that are sparsely filled; Fridays are especially quiet. Please consider giving an hour. If you can commit to one hour per week, please fill out a card on the table at the Adoration Chapel to be added to the Adoration Register. Thank you.

GUIDED HOLY HOUR
The Holy Hour has paused for the duration of the Novena and will again resume after Christmas.

SICK VISITATIONS
Fr Bradley will visit the sick and housebound in his care on Wed 28 Oct in the town areas and on Thurs 29 Oct in the country areas.

READINGS FOR 30TH SUNDAY IN OT
1st Reading: It is c.1200 BC. In this passage the Lord is teaching his people something never before heard in the religions of the world. As much as the Lord cares for us as his beloved creation, he vehemently requires us to care for one another, especially the weakest and most defenceless among us. There is a strict prohibition here against usury between the rich individual and the poor person in need.
2nd Reading: This letter is the earliest writing of the New Testament. Paul compliments his converts from Thessaly on having taken to the Gospel "with the joy of the Holy Spirit", in spite of serious opposition. News of how they had broken with idolatry had already "spread everywhere" (even without the Internet!).
Gospel: In this Gospel reading Jesus is in Jerusalem. Before long he will be arrested by the chief priests and elders. He uses their carefully contrived questions to reveal ever more about God and our relationship with Him. Love of God and of neighbour cannot be separated. 'Herin lies the difference between Jesus' teaching and that of the scribes and Pharisees.' (Glenstal Bible Missal)

ANNUAL MASS FOR THE DEAD
The Annual Parish Mass for the Dead will take place on
Friday 27 November at 7pm in St Mary's, Cockhill.
Families who have been bereaved from mid-October 2025–31 October 2026 will be contacted in the next few weeks, but there will be an opportunity on the night for any family to bring forward a candle for someone who has died.
Candles will be on sale in the porch of the church on the night for €5.
All Welcome.

PARISH DRAW

Friday 16 October: Week 18
1st Prize: €500
Liam Magee, St Oran's Road
Promoter: Parish Office
2nd Prize: €300
Christy Porter, St Egney's Terrace
Promoter: Bridget Hepper
3rd Prize: €150
MarieTherese McDaid, c/o Promoter
Promoter: Angela Harkin

COCKHILL GRAVEYARD
Please note the gates of the graveyard in Cockhill will now close at 6pm for the duration of Daylight Saving Time.

LECTIO DIVINA (Praying with Scripture) takes place each Wed after 10am Mass in St Teresa's Room. Come and join us for a cuppa and prayer.
THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word'* series of 4 Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome
SCOIL ÍOSAGÁIN: ENROLMENT/
Application Forms for children starting school in Sept 2027 are available from Mon 12th Oct from the school Reception (entrance opposite the Grotto). Closing date for receipt of applications is Fri 13 Nov at 3pm. For further information please ring the school at 0749362450 or contact principal@scoiliosagain.ie
SOCIAL TEA DANCE Eamon Cutliffe's 80th birthday social tea dance with Revival Band and guests Maria Fitzpatrick, Caroline Cutliffe, and Bernie Doherty on Sun 25 Oct at The Plaza Buncrana. 8pm-10pm Adm €10. Come along and hear all your favourite songs, jiving, line dancing and dance tunes.
MARY'S MEALS If you have any old notes or coins that you wish to donate to Mary's Meals, they can be dropped off to Mc Kenna's Londis, Buncrana on Fri 30 Oct between 9.30am and 5.30pm. Otherwise, collection can be arranged by contacting Eilis Conneely on 0877060457. Thank you for your kind support.
COFFEE MORNING Fionán Bradley is holding a coffee morning in St Mary's Hall, Buncrana on Fri 30 Oct from 10am-2pm as part of his fundraising efforts for Buncrana GAA's Quid Games. Fionán's chosen charity is Buncrana Community Hospital. Anyone willing to bake something for the coffee morning please give him a call on 0861245348
WANTED Piano for Plaza Youth Centre. Music/piano lessons starting. (Not confined to youth). Ring: 087 291 3186

BANK HOLIDAY
The Parish Office will be closed on Mon 26 Oct and re-open at 9am on Tuesday 27.

BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.buncranacinema.ie

Get the latest show times straight to your inbox: Buncranacinema.ie/subscribe

CLAYFACE 16 | 110mins
Sat 24th & Sun 25th
8.15pm
Mon 26th - Thurs 29th
8.15pm

DISNEY JUNIOR CLUB G | 70mins
Sat 24th 5pm
Matinee Sun 25th
3pm

MOVIES & TEA
Death Becomes Her (1992)
Tues 27th Oct 1-4pm
€10 incl Afternoon Tea
Carers go free

BINGO

St Mary's Hall
Fridays at 8pm
Single book €11
Double €17
Snowball: €5550

Community Corner

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE Drumfries Walking Group will be meeting on Fri 30 Oct at Dunree beach car park, at 10am everyone welcome. New 6 week block of **Pulmonary Exercises** starts on Mon 2 Nov at 10am. This class is suitable for anyone with breathing issues looking to improve fitness and mobility. Please call the centre on 0749361742 for more information.
THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept 'no', listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa's Room.
AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else's drinking) meet in St Teresa's Room on Thurs at 6:45pm.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa's Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction.
GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329.
THE PLAZA Dance Classes *Tues* from 10:30am. From ***Wed:*** **Junior Line Dancing & Jiving Class** 5pm-6pm. **Beginners Line Dancing** 6:15pm-7:15pm. **Advanced Line Dancing** 7:30pm-8:30pm. ***Mon:*** **A Beginners Line Dancing and Jiving Class** at the Laurentic 7:30pm-9pm. Hall available for hire & for children's birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317
INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. HSE encourages parents to protect babies this winter. Inishowen Medical is hosting **RSV vaccination clinics** in early October. Parents of babies born between the 1st Mar and 31st Aug 2026, who wish to avail of this vaccine, should contact us to book a vaccine apt with Nurse/Midwife Fogarty.
CRANA COLLEGE SCHOOL MUSICAL "Shrek" will take place in The Millennium Forum on Monday 9 and Tuesday 10 November. Tickets on sale from The Millennium Forum's website. Come and enjoy a night of music, dancing and fantastic local talent.
DOG FREE ZONE A reminder that dogs are not permitted in Cockhill or Desertegney graveyards. Thank you.

SLIMMING WORLD Buncrana: The Exchange every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall** every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. **Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall** every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705.
INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296
PARK RUN Come and join the us on Saturday mornings at 9am on the shore front by the play park.
GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS for people living with Parkinson's every Wednesday at 2pm in The Exchange.
COCKHILL CEILI CLUB Classes on Thursdays in Cockhill Hall. 8pm-9.30pm. Beginners Welcome.
GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA Give us a call on 074 9361988 or email gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don't speak Irish, don't worry. That won't hold your child back.
COMMUNITY EMPLOYMENT PROGRAMME Vacancies for a grounds worker for the graveyard at St Mary's Cockhill. Contact buncrana@swillycep.ie for more info
BUNCRANA PARENT AND TODDLERS' GROUP Wednesdays and Thursdays from 10am to 11:45am in St Mary's Hall.
CRAZY PAVING EXPERT Buncrana Area call 0871923511
FOUND A Nissan car key near Tullydish Bridge. Contact 0860686048
IRISH GRINDS specialising in Oral and Grammar for LC. Wednesday availability. Experienced Tutor. WhatsApp: +353 0872408308
BUNCRANA COMMUNITY LIBRARY has a reusable party pack available to borrow with your library card. This contains: plates, cups, jugs, trays, bowls, bunting and cutlery. Ring 074 93 61941 for further info
BUNCRANA LIBRARY Chess playing meet ups takes place on Saturdays in Buncrana Community library from 11am to 1 pm. No bookings required just drop in. All ages welcome. Ring 0749361941 for further info.
RACHEL'S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181
NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911
SAMARITANS Call Free **116 123,** Text **087 2609090.**

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 00353 749102233 **ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108**

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time - Year A - 25th October 2026
Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com
Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com
Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:34-40)*

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognize the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 4th November at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio.

Remembering Our Deceased Loved Ones Special Remembrance Masses for those who have died from our parishes in the past year will be celebrated as follows:

Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane: Tuesday 3rd November at 7.00 pm

Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road: Thursday 5th November at 7.00 pm

St Patrick's Church, Murlog: Friday 6th November at 7.00 pm.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord and let perpetual light shine upon them.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of
Maureen McCrossan, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane;
Rosemary Donnell, Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg;
Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries Sean Carlin, Margaret Daly, Thomas Daly, Margaret Devine, Jenny Doherty, John Doherty, Brad Doherty Snr, Ann Farry, Raymond Foley, Kathleen Gamble, Catherine Hannigan, Tony Hannigan, Stim Hughes, Patrick Kennedy, Paschal McCallion, Tommy McDaid, Edie McDermott, Alex McDonald, Kathleen McGill, George McGinley, Rose McGrath, Pam McLaughlin, Bridie McMenamin, Eileen Porter, Tony Stewart. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:
Leckpatrick £1,163.91 (£549 Missions)
Clonleigh €1,726.23 (€275.61 Missions)
Camus £1,645.97, (£636.33 Missions)
Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 1st November (All Saints):
1st Reading: Revelation 7:2-4, 9-14;
Psalm: 24:1-2, 3-4, 5-6;
2nd Reading: John 3:1-3;
Gospel: Matthew 5:1-12

Saints of the Coming Week:
Tuesday St Otteran, monk;
Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles;
Thursday St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop;
Friday St John of Capistrano, priest;
Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Please Note that from Monday 2nd November, weekday Mass at **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road** will be at **7.45 am**. We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at **St Patrick's, Murlog** is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notice. We thank you all for your co-operation and understanding.

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Day of Prayer, **Praise and Healing,** celebrating 50 years takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration: 9.30 am, concluding with Mass in the afternoon. Theme: People of God's Delight (Ps 194.4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. Cost £40 (includes coffee and lunch). Please contact Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041 by 1st November to book (for catering purposes).

Parish Draw The October parish draw for Camus / Leckpatrick takes place on Thursday 29th October at 7.30 pm in the parochial house, Ballymagorry. Please return outstanding payments to your promoter or to the parish office. Good luck.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd - 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

St Patrick's, Dungannon Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Event: Saturday 5th December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00 am and concluding with Mass at 3.00 pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "… with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 3rd November and 1st December from 8 - 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Diocesan Priesthood? There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood in Derry on Sunday 8th November at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th - 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com

The Columban Young Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on **Thursday 19th Nov at 7.00 pm** at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. We are seeking new members. Please come along and bring a friend! For information, please contact columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Knock, Co Mayo from Friday 9th - Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets on Wednesday 28th October from 12.30 pm - 1.30 pm at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00 pm, beginning this Sunday, 25th October. The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us. Join us also via https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Job Opportunity St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry is recruiting an experienced Choir Director (10 hours per week) to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir, ensuring that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description / application pack, please contact (028) 71262302 / recruitment@derrydiocese.org Completed applications must be submitted to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP or to recruitment@derrydiocese.org by noon on Thursday 12th November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. Applications from men and women and from members of all communities welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. Some fun, excitement and slight competition. Everyone welcome.

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Centre 2000, 21-27 Moyle Rd, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP on 30th Oct from 12.30 - 4 pm & 5 - 7 pm. Visit https://nibts.bookinglive.com/book/add/p/6 / tel 08085534653.

A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett from Fri 6th - Sun 8th November at Termonbacca, An opportunity for prayer, reflection and to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or Termonbacca Derry | Derry | Facebook

Gamblers Anon Tel 71351329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am
Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm
St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.00 pm**; Sunday: 9.45 am
St Mary's Cloughcor: Sunday 8.30am (25th Oct - alternate Sundays - 8th Nov)
St Joseph's Glenmornan: Sunday 8.30am (1st Nov - alternate Sundays – 15th Nov)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
Tuesday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).
10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
Thursday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Friday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.
Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.**
Office hours: Monday - Thursday 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday 9.30 am - 12.30 pm. Feel free to call in or phone on 028 71882215.
Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.
A Small Collection of Candles, Mass cards / Mass bouquets available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.
St Pio prayer cards also available.
A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash /cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995.

Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23.

https://www.cappaghparish.com

Cappagh Parish News

Twenty-Eighth Sunday in Ordinary Time

11th October 2026

St Mary's Killyclogher, St Mary's Knockmoyle, Corpus Christi Mountfield, Christ The King Strathroy

Mass Schedule

St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher
Sunday Mass: 9am & 11:15am
Vigil: 6.30pm (during October)
Daily Mass: 10am: Mon, Tues, Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat

Christ the King Church, Strathroy
Sunday Mass: 12noon
Evening Mass: 7:30pm: Tues

St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher
Confessions: After Saturday morning Mass
Confessions: 5:45pm-6.15pm: Saturday
Daily Rosary: 9:10am: Monday-Saturday
Legion of Mary: Every Monday after 10am Mass
Children's Liturgy Group: 11:15am Sunday Mass in KC

Christ the King Church, Strathroy
Holy Souls Prayer Group: 1st Thurs every month

Corpus Christi Church, Mountfield
Rosary: Every Thursday at 8pm

St. Mary's Church, Knockmoyle
Rosary: Every Tuesday at 8pm, during October

Morning Reflection Prayer for Self Confidence

Heavenly Father, Thank You for the gift of a new day.
As I begin this morning, help me to remember that my worth is found in You and not in the opinions of others or in my own doubts. Fill my heart with confidence, not pride, but the quiet assurance that I am created with purpose and loved without condition. Help me to recognise the gifts You have placed within me and give me the courage to use them wisely. When fear or insecurity tries to take hold, remind me that I do not walk alone.
Strengthen my mind, guide my words, and help me face each challenge with faith rather than worry.
Teach me to believe in the person You are shaping me to become.
May I carry myself with kindness, speak with confidence, and trust that Your plans for me are good.
Today, let me walk with peace, knowing that I am enough because I am Yours. Amen.

Our Lady of Silence Abbey

Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly

17th October 2026 / Gormanston, Co Meath / "Is not this what God asks of you?" (Micah 6:8)

The Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland.

The Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the Working Document and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?" Scan the QR code to access the Working Document.

Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more at www.derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly.

Parish Office Opening Hours: Monday –Thursday: 9am-5pm *(closed 1-1.30pm)*
Contact: Phone 028 8224 3375 or Email info@cappaghparish.com.

Anniversary Mass Bookings: A Requiem Mass takes precedence and therefore your booking is subject to change. Please note that an Anniversary or Months Mind Mass may be shared with others.

Watch Mass Live on the parish webcam: www.cappaghparish.com
Webcam live streams only. The recording of services broadcast on the webcam ***must be requested in advance*** by contacting the parish office on 028 8224 3375 or speaking with the priest (outside of office opening hours)

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org
Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org
SVP CTK : 07738838066 **SVP KC :** 07738837992

Cappagh (& Killyclogher amalgamated)



Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

24th & 25th October 2026

(30th Sunday in Ordinary Time)

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm

Sunday 1st November, Feast of All Saints Mass 9 & 11 am.
Mass for deceased parishioners at 7pm Monday 2nd November.

Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses

Sat 24th Oct	Fr. Farrelly 7pm
Sun 25th Oct	Annie Doherty, Ballyloskey (5th Anniv) 9am
Mon 26th Oct	Mary Joe McGonagle, Tiernaleague 10am
Fri 30th Oct	Cancer sufferers and survivors 7pm
Sat 31st Oct	Paddy McCrossan, Millbrae (1st Anniv) 7pm
Sun 1st Nov	Sean McDaid, Magherarnett 9am
Wed 4th Nov	Brian Gurney, Ard Clochar (2nd Anniv) 10am
Fri 6th Nov	Tony Cantwell & Karol Cantwell, Gortlarry (1st& 20thAnniv) 7pm
Sat 7th Nov	Martina O'Connor, Hollymount (30th Anniv) 7pm
Sun 8th Nov	Sr. Brendan 9am
Mon 9th Nov	Brendan Flanagan, Norria, Lagg (Month's Mind) 10am

Anniversaries at this time

Philip Donaghey, Glack & Bedford. Thomas Smith, Churchtown.
Ann O'Connor, Malin Rd. Mary McLaughlin, Gleneely.
Willie & Nellie Doherty, Glack.

Weekly Collection amounted to € 2780.98 & Stg £ 101.14
Thank you for your generosity



Baptisms: We welcome into God's family:
Senán Owen Diver, Carrickafoden

Good As New for Church funds open at the back of the parish office. All washed and clean donations are welcome. Tel. Bernie on 0861734977 or Don on 0868554796.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

VOCATIONS: St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us.

The Columban Young Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation next Thursday 19 November, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend! For any further information please contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend, St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo Friday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Masses and Baptisms: If you wish to book Masses or Baptisms please call into the Sacristy before or after any Masses or telephone **0860577273.** Parish Office, Macartan's, Carndonagh, Co. Donegal. *Tel:(074)9374104 Email:sacredheartchurchcarn@gmail.com*

SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026
Thirtieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:
Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 26 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm
Tuesday 27 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 28 Oct	Liturgy of Word with Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 29 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 30 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	Mass, 7.30pm
Saturday 31 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm: Induction Mass of Fr Chris McDermott
Sunday 1 Nov: All Saints Day	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am: *Additional Mass for All Saints Day* Drumnabey,12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am: *Month's Mind, Brendan Cassidy*

ST PATRICK'S, DRUMQUIN – Fr Chris McDermott will be formally inducted as Parish Priest of Langfield (Drumquin) next Saturday evening, 31 October, by Bishop Michael Router, at an Installation Ceremony at the 5.00pm Vigil Mass in St Patrick's Church.
In looking forward to welcoming Fr Chris to Drumquin, we also welcome Bishop Router to the parish for the first time. There will be tea in the hall for everyone afterwards and a chance to meet the new Parish Priest and the new Bishop!

Fr Chris' induction as Parish Priest of Aghyaran is scheduled to take place at the 7.30pm Vigil Mass on Saturday 7 November and then in Ardstraw West & Castlederg at the 11.00am Mass in Castlederg on Sunday 22 November. Further details next week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,262 & €11.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,756 & €74, made up of:
Castlederg £938 & €59, **Drumnabey** £557 & €15, **Dregish** £261. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,078.
Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In September these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £881 & €20 CRF £692; **Ardstraw West Castlederg:** £2,394; **Drumquin:** £2,245.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The October draw will take place after Mass in Dregish today.

SVP Meeting takes place this Wednesday, 28 October, in the Parochial House, Drumquin, at 7.30pm.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Rosemary Donnell, late of 10 Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg, whose Funeral Mass took place in Strabane on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Rosemary's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

PLEASE NOTE the following dates for November Masses remembering those who have died in the past year.
A candle in remembrance of each of those who have died will be lit:

CASTLEDERG: Monday 2 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Joe Gallagher, Pat Carolan, James Murray, Delma MvGlynn, Ellen Sweeney, Tom McHugh, Derek Duggan, Pat Keenan, Marrie McMenamin, Ann T. Doherty, Angela Laird, Doris Gallagher, Colleen Vukusic (nee Masterson), Brendan Douglas, Charlie Logue, Christine Clarke, Michael Harper, Evelyn Baxter, Molly Carlin.

AGHYARAN: Friday 6 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Noel Doherty, Ellen Lynch, Peter Moss, Madge McNamee, Danny Gallen, Danny O'Donnell, Don Browne.

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 7 November, 5.00pm, remembering: Mickey McLaughlin, Margaret McLaughlin, Tommy Kearney, Margaret McLaughlin, Cameron Donnelly, Paddy Gallagher, Fiona Scott, Joe Campbell, Gerry O'Kane, Frankie Breen, Brendan Cassidy.

DREGISH: Sunday 8 November, 9.30am, remembering Kay Nugent.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 8 November, 12.30pm, remembering: Hannah Devine, Terry Logue, Brendan (Bo) Lennon.

Families who have been bereaved in the past year are asked to check that the name of their loved one has been included above. If you have any query, please contact the Parish Office.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Sat 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments served.

BEGINNERS' UPHOLSTERY CLASS in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, Thursday 5 November, 6.30pm to 9.00pm. Cost £10 and booking is essential. All materials supplied. For information or to book, contact Claire on 07818091136.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dregish History Group invite you to a Book Launch in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Fri 13 Nov, at 7.30pm; refreshments will be served. The Group has produced two books, available at the event for purchase. One contains a selection of interesting local history articles by members of the Dregish History Group called ***'Gathering Hidden Gems on the History of Dregish and the People Together'.*** The second is a history of the ***Clergy of Adrstraw West*** by Brian Devenney, edited by Fr McCawille. Thank you to NLH Fund and Rapid for their support.

THANK YOU: Deborah Lowry offers her thanks to all who supported in any way the ***Team Hope Garden Tea Party*** at her home in September. She is most appreciative of the generosity shown by the entire community and is delighted to share that the event raised almost £5,000. The funds raised will support Team Hope's longer-term development work, helping vulnerable families and communities overseas to build more secure and hopeful futures.

TEAM HOPE CHRISTMAS SHOE-BOX APPEAL for children in Africa and Eastern Europe: You are invited to fill a wrapped shoebox with gifts using the 4Ws - something to Write, Wash, Wear and Wow, and include a €6 contribution towards transport and delivery. Shoeboxes can be dropped off between 1 and 10 Nov at Castle Coffee, or Urban Barn/Pet Store, both in Castlederg. For further details, labels and guidance, visit www.teamhope.ie. Thank you, from Deborah Lowry and all at Team Hope!

As our parishes prepare to welcome Fr Chris next weekend, Fr Thomas and I take this opportunity to wish him every blessing in his ministry in Aghyaran, Ardstraw West & Castlederg and Drumquin.

Born in 1986, Fr Chris is a native of Leckpatrick Parish. His parents, Rosemary and Sean, live in Strabane. Fr Chris tells us that his three brothers, two nieces and a nephew form his closest family. Following school, Chris was employed for several years in an administrative role at the Oncology Department of Altnagelvin Hospital. He subsequently pursued seminary studies at St Malachy's College, Belfast, and St Patrick's College, Maynooth. Since ordination in June 2016, Fr Chris has ministered among the faith communities of St Eugene's Cathedral in Derry, Drumragh (Omagh), Limavady, Kilrea & Desertoghill, Errigal (Garvagh) and Granaghan (Swatragh).

Fr Chris says that, after spending the last five years 'on the missions' in Co Derry, he now looks forward to serving the people of the West Tyrone Pastoral Area. He and Kobe (the pet dog) will take up residence in Castlederg Parochial House at the end of the month.

Fr Chris brings many gifts to his ministry and, in giving generously of himself to serving the people entrusted to his care, I know that he will enjoy the support and encouragement of you all. I pray God's blessing on all that you will share and accomplish together.

Please keep Fr Chris in your prayers as he prepares to move to Castlederg and begin the next chapter of his priestly ministry in the West Tyrone Pastoral Area.

May God bless you all,

Fr Paul.

Culdaff
Fr John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119
Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107
www.culdaffparish.com
email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass
Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am [Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm];
Thursday, 7.30 pm;
Friday, **10 am**, Mass and Burial of Ashes of Mary Ryan (nee Doherty) Ballyharry; **Saturday** 11 am.

Confessions Before Saturday nights Mass, 7.30 – 7.50

Saturday Vigil [Feast of All Saints] 8 pm
Sunday [All Saints Day]10 am.

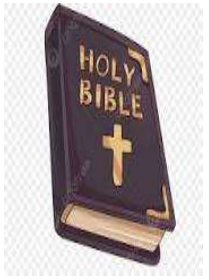
Anniversary Mass this weekend
Saturday Vigil 8 pm: Mary & Patrick Duncan, Croragh and Laura Finnegan, Kerry

Next Weekend
Saturday 8 pm James Morgan, Carndonagh [1st Anniversary]
Sunday 10 am Kathleen McDermott, Leitrim [1st Anniversary]

Weekly Offering €1,080
Mission Sunday Collection €520

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading
Exodus 22:20-26
The Lord teaches that compassion ought to be shown to the alien and to the poor.
Second Reading
1 Thessalonians 1:5c-10
Paul tells the Thessalonians that their conversion to the Lord has been an example to all believers.
Gospel Reading
Matthew 22:34-40
The Pharisees continue to test Jesus with a question about the greatest commandment.



VOCATIONS - St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

We will have a **Memory Tree** on the Altar during the Month of November. You are invited to write the names of your departed family members, on the labels provided, and hang them on the tree. They will be remembered at each Mass in the church, culminating in our **Annual Mass for all the Dead of the Parish** on Sunday, 29th November.



Greencastle Centre - Gwyneth & Sarahs Art Camp Tues 27th Oct 10am-1pm €30 Call/Text/WhatsApp 083 462 7073.
- Memories & Mementoes Scrapbooking course 6 weeks starting Thursday 22nd October 7–9pm €30 for 6 weeks.
- FREE high-Vis vests available at reception.
- Beekeeping for Beginners 6 week course starting Saturday 7th November 11am- 1pm.

Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061
The **Sunday Night Dance** will take place this Sunday, 25th October, 8-10.30pm. Old time, ceilidh, line dancing and jiving. Admission €5.
Places available on our **creative writing, woodwork, digital skills for farmers, plumbing, Christmas wreath making, Christmas Centrepiece, Christmas lanterns, and Kid's Halloween craft** courses. Contact the centre for more information and to book.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. ***The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'.*** Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us.

Culdaff FC Annual Bazaar will be held in Bocan Hall on Sunday 6th Dec. Entry is free and there will be the usual array of prizes, teas/ coffee & snacks and a visit from the man himself Santa Claus. Doors will open at 4.30pm and further updates nearer the time.

Men's Sherd -Still time to go to Thursday's class at the Men's Shed Carn. Are you nervous about going online ? This is the one for you. A FREE Course, from 11 am - 1 pm for four weeks. An IT taster course to teach you to navigate the internet, shop safely, send emails etc. Contact Denis at 074 93 62218 or email denis@inishowen.ie Runs every Thursday in October.

Whist
1st Vera Deeny
2nd Eileen Gormley
3rd Rose Thompson
Gerard Doherty

Tickets Patrick McLaughlin, Betty Doherty, Kevin Lafferty
Other Winners Patrick McLaughlin, John McLaughlin, Dolores O'Donnell, Kevin Lafferty

CULDAFF TIDY TOWNS This year's annual Culdaff Craft Fair will take place on Sunday 15 November from 2-5pm in the Wee Hall Culdaff. Afternoon teas served and a draw for valuable prizes will take place. For more information and bookings contact Philomena on 0868418189.

Spraoi agus Spórt Activities for Children and Families
Parent & Toddler Sensory Play - Tuesdays, 10am-1pm.
Mammy & Baby - Wednesdays, 10am-1pm.
Parent & Toddler Messy Play - Thursdays, 10am-1pm.
Unit 6, SuperValu, Carndonagh, F93 AY6D.
Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
Spraoi na Samhna
Spraoi na Samhna at Spraoi agus Spórt, Carndonagh, offers lots of Halloween activities including a pumpkin patch, slime-making, sewing, cupcake decorating, gaming and coding camps. Parent & Toddler sessions feature sensory play, messy play and baby groups. Events run 24th–30th October. Book at spraoiagussport.ie.
Charities Institute Ireland Awards
Spraoi agus Spórt has been shortlisted for three 2026 People's Choice Awards with Charities Institute Ireland. Finance Team of the Year, Fundraising Team of the Year, and Charity of the Year. Show your support by voting at https://bit.ly/4zbnAxX and enter a draw to win an Amazon Echo Dot.

Serenity House Linocut Card Making and Calligraphy course starting Wednesday 4th November 7pm - 9pm.
Serenity House is proud to be a drop off point for the Christmas Shoebox Appeal appeal 2026 again this year. All boxes must be in Serenity House by Monday 9th November.

Moville Celtic Christmas Market (Christmas crafts, Santa's grotto) on Saturday 5 December 1-5pm. Stalls available for €20.

Tea in Bocan Hall next Sunday, 1st November, after 10 am Mass. All welcome.

Greencastle Centre - Thanks to everyone who donated to our church gate collection last week.
- Balance With Bronagh Halloween Special Saturday 31st October 11am – 11:45am Tel: 00447827057701.
- Christmas Wreath Workshop Thursday 26th November 7pm – 9pm contact Hayley to book: 00447947431574.
- Christmas Craft Fair Saturday 21st November 12pm – 3pm tables only €20.
- Citizens Advice drop-in every Wednesday 9:30am – 4:30pm.

Remember Clocks go **back** 1 hour tonight.

CHIROPODIST CLINIC Patricia Barne will a end St Columbcille Centre, Clonmany on Wed Oct 28 from 9am-2pm. For an appointment call 0749363282.

POINTS TO PONDER –
25 October 2026
To love the Lord with all our heart – is this even possible? A common assumption is that love must just come, that it grows organically, and that it cannot be forced. That's infatuation, not true love. Any kind of love – for a parent, spouse, child, or friend – will reach a point during which it is no longer easy. For love to be true, it must be a free choice and commitment.

'All your heart, soul, and mind' sounds rather extreme, even rather dangerous. The world says that loving anyone totally is a risky proposition – what if the one we love rejects us or lets us down, leaving us with nothing? And the world is even more terrified to love God totally, who cannot even be seen.
This makes sense; after all, to love totally is to trust that we will find fulfillment precisely by not looking for it ourselves, but by looking to fulfill someone else. That old, almost clichéd phrase, 'love grows when it is given away,' is actually spot-on in this regard.

True love takes a leap of faith, which is what frightens nonbelievers. Many people are okay with going to church every now and then or volunteering for a charity from time to time (and posting it on Instagram, of course).
Loving like that does not require us to make any kind of leap, any kind of definitive change, any commitment. But loving God with everything means that all we do is for love of him. We trust that he will take care of us. That is heroic; that is what it means to be a saint

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
'Remember that nothing is small in the eyes of God. Do all that you do with love.'
Saint Thérèse of Lisieux
'We have been called to heal wounds, to unite what has fallen apart, and to bring home those who have lost their way.' *Saint Francis of Assisi*
'I invite all Christians, everywhere, at this very moment, to a renewed personal encounter with Jesus Christ, or at least an openness to letting him encounter them; I ask all of you to do this unfailingly each day.' *Pope Francis (EG 3)*

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Síochána, Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 00353 749102233 ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108

CULMORE PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

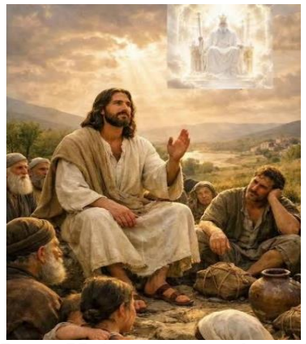
Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

CULMORE PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.

Parish of Dunboe, Macosquin and Aghadowey

Sunday 25th October 2026

Year A Psalter Week II



Rev Neil Farren PP. Chapelfield, 59 Laurel Hill Road, Coleraine BT51 3PY Tele: 028 7034 3130

Parish Secretary: Clare White at Chapelfield

Office hours This week:

Monday 26th October – OFFICE CLOSED
Tuesday 27th October – OFFICE CLOSED
Thursday 29th October – OFFICE CLOSED

Parish Email: cpdma@btinternet.com
Parish Website: www.dmaparish.com
SVP Helpline: Tel: 07752017340
Safeguarding Officer: Mrs Bernadette Eastwood

Emergency Calls: Father Neil Farren - 07710860966

Age Concern Tele 02870357966
Good morning, Causeway For elderly and vulnerable people. Tele 02870558005
Lifeline Crisis Response Helpline 0808 808 8000
North Coast Community Transport Tele 02870321234
Samaritans Tele 116123
St Vincent de Paul Tele 07752017340
Wave Trauma Centre for Mental Health and Wellbeing Tele 0282766990 **Women's Aid** Tele 02870356
Onus – Men & Women affected by domestic or sexual abuse in NI – 0808 802 1414 (Freephone 24hr)

Anniversaries

John McGill (Anniversary Mass Tues 27th Oct St Johns), Kevin Greene, Paddy Donnelly (Anniversary Mass Sunday 25th 11am), Hugh Miller, Jim McQuade, Freda & Geoff Dudgen.

We Pray

St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Parish Collections 17th & 18th October 2026

	St Johns	Aghadowey	Dunboe
Weekly:	£744.68	£210.50	£140.00
Loose:	£294.97	£20.15	£25.60
Total:	£1435.90		

Masses - week commencing 26th October

Church	St Johns	Dunboe	Aghadowey
Monday	10am		
Tuesday	10am		
Wednesday	7pm		
Thursday	10am		12pm
Friday	10am		
Saturday	6pm	7.30pm	
Sunday Feast of All Saints	11am		9.45am

Dunboe Reader/ Offertory Rota

Saturday 24th October – Ann / Offertory – Seamus & Linda
Saturday 31st October – Brenda / Offertory – Alice & Michael
Saturday 7th November – Catherine / Offertory – Martin & Philomena

Dunboe Eucharistic Minister Rota

Saturday 24th October – Maggie
Saturday 31st October – Vincent
Saturday 7th November – Linda
Saturday 14th November – Karen

Dunboe Cleaning & Flowers Rota

November - Catherine McNally

St Johns Eucharistic Minister

Saturday 31st – Sharon Boorman
Sunday 1st November – Liam McLaughlin

St Johns Minister of the Word November

Vigil: Nuala
Sunday Mass: Anita

Aghadowey Offertory

Sunday 25th October – Kathleen & Eva McBride
Sunday 1st November – Bill & Eilish
Sunday 8th November – Christopher & Kathleen Owens
Sunday 15th November – Paddy & Violet Dempsey

Aghadowey Cleaning rota

November - Ava Clarke & Lauren Gibson

Sick Visitation

Monday – Dunboe & Articlave area
Thursday Aghadowey

Christmas Wreath Making

Save the Date, for our Christmas Wreath Making Class in Aghadowey Hall ***Wednesday 16th December at 7.00pm.*** Message to book your place **07746618857.**



All Saints Day Pilgrim Walk

On **Sunday 1st November**. From the Convent steps to St Patricks Holy well (Tubber Patrick).
Meeting at 3pm and walking up the steps along the Convent walk towards Portstewart Strand, just before the Strand on the brow of the hill, is St Patricks Well.

All are welcome to join us!

ARK (Aghadowey Rural Kinship)

Monday 26th October at 8pm in the Brown Trout Inn.
"Stories of the Local People at Home and Abroad "
Speaker:
Ms. Fiona Pegrum QG Family Historian.
Admission £8 including supper.
Members £5.

Everyone very Welcome.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION COURSES

January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking. The courses can be booked on the website at www.accordni.com JANUARY 29TH/30TH 2027 FEBRUARY 19TH/20TH 2027 MARCH 19TH/20TH 2027. E mail; derry@accordni.com. Web; www.accordni.com

Parish Draw - October

£500 – Fr Frank Moloney
£100 – Vera Law
£100 – Winifred Gribbon
£100 – Patrick Dempsey
£50 – Sheila Mc Gonigle
£50 – Kathleen Connolly
£50 – Sean Kelly
Congratulations to all our winners!

RISE & SHINE TRUST - Group 110 (Derry)

Do you know a young person who would benefit from a week of friendship, fun, faith and unforgettable memories in Lourdes? Rise & Shine Trust brings children (11+) and young adults with additional needs on a week-long pilgrimage holiday to Lourdes each Easter. The trip is free for our guests as our volunteers fundraise for it. For more information, and to apply, please see www.riseandshine.ie.

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry,

10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

SMA Fathers Annual Subscription

Envelopes for the SMA Fathers annual subscription will be left at the back of Our Lady of the Assumption chapel Aghadowey for your donation. Many thanks, Karen Hanna and Maura Creelman

SVP Senior Citizens Night out

St John's SVP Conference is hosting a 'Senior Citizen Night Out' for St John's Parish at the Lodge Hotel on **Monday 16 November at 6pm.**
The evening begins with a free draw, followed by a two-course meal and music by Henry Gaile & Bernadette Quinn.
Tickets for a second draw will be sold after the meal.
Places are limited. To reserve yours, you must book and make a minimum donation of £10.
Payment is due by Wednesday 11th November.
Leave your name, contact number and donation in the sacristy at St John's to book, or contact Anne on 07789306587.
Bookings close on Wednesday 11th November.

Save The Date……



Sunday 13th December, our Annual Carol Service in St Mary's Church, followed by our annual Bazaar, cake sale and December draw.

More details to follow in due course!



SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 2026
Thirtieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:
Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 26 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm
Tuesday 27 Oct	Mass, 10.00am	Rosary, Castlederg: 2.00pm	Rosary, 10.00am
Wednesday 28 Oct	Liturgy of Word with Holy Communion: 10.00am	Castlederg: Liturgy of the Word, with Holy Communion: 10.00am Dregish: Rosary, 11.00am	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 29 Oct	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 30 Oct		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	Mass, 7.30pm
Saturday 31 Oct	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm: Induction Mass of Fr Chris McDermott
Sunday 1 Nov: All Saints Day	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am: *Additional Mass for All Saints Day* Drumnabey,12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am: *Month's Mind, Brendan Cassidy*

ST PATRICK'S, DRUMQUIN – Fr Chris McDermott will be formally inducted as Parish Priest of Langfield (Drumquin) next Saturday evening, 31 October, by Bishop Michael Router, at an Installation Ceremony at the 5.00pm Vigil Mass in St Patrick's Church.
In looking forward to welcoming Fr Chris to Drumquin, we also welcome Bishop Router to the parish for the first time. There will be tea in the hall for everyone afterwards and a chance to meet the new Parish Priest and the new Bishop!

Fr Chris' induction as Parish Priest of Aghyaran is scheduled to take place at the 7.30pm Vigil Mass on Saturday 7 November and then in Ardstraw West & Castlederg at the 11.00am Mass in Castlederg on Sunday 22 November. Further details next week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:
AGHYARAN: £1,262 & €11.
ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,756 & €74, made up of:
Castlederg £938 & €59, **Drumnabey** £557 & €15, **Dregish** £261. **DRUMQUIN:** £1,078.
Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In September these amounted to:
Aghyaran: £881 & €20 CRF £692; **Ardstraw West Castlederg:** £2,394; **Drumquin:** £2,245.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: The October draw will take place after Mass in Dregish today.

SVP Meeting takes place this Wednesday, 28 October, in the Parochial House, Drumquin, at 7.30pm.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Rosemary Donnell, late of 10 Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg, whose Funeral Mass took place in Strabane on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Rosemary's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

PLEASE NOTE the following dates for November Masses remembering those who have died in the past year.
A candle in remembrance of each of those who have died will be lit:

CASTLEDERG: Monday 2 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Joe Gallagher, Pat Carolan, James Murray, Delma MvGlynn, Ellen Sweeney, Tom McHugh, Derek Duggan, Pat Keenan, Marrie McMenamin, Ann T. Doherty, Angela Laird, Doris Gallagher, Colleen Vukusic (nee Masterson), Brendan Douglas, Charlie Logue, Christine Clarke, Michael Harper, Evelyn Baxter, Molly Carlin.

AGHYARAN: Friday 6 November, 7.30pm, remembering: Noel Doherty, Ellen Lynch, Peter Moss, Madge McNamee, Danny Gallen, Danny O'Donnell, Don Browne.

DRUMQUIN: Saturday 7 November, 5.00pm, remembering: Mickey McLaughlin, Margaret McLaughlin, Tommy Kearney, Margaret McLaughlin, Cameron Donnelly, Paddy Gallagher, Fiona Scott, Joe Campbell, Gerry O'Kane, Frankie Breen, Brendan Cassidy.

DREGISH: Sunday 8 November, 9.30am, remembering Kay Nugent.

DRUMNABEY: Sunday 8 November, 12.30pm, remembering: Hannah Devine, Terry Logue, Brendan (Bo) Lennon.

Families who have been bereaved in the past year are asked to check that the name of their loved one has been included above. If you have any query, please contact the Parish Office.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Sat 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments served.

BEGINNERS' UPHOLSTERY CLASS in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, Thursday 5 November, 6.30pm to 9.00pm. Cost £10 and booking is essential. All materials supplied. For information or to book, contact Claire on 07818091136.

BOOK LAUNCH: Dregish History Group invite you to a Book Launch in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Fri 13 Nov, at 7.30pm; refreshments will be served. The Group has produced two books, available at the event for purchase. One contains a selection of interesting local history articles by members of the Dregish History Group called ***'Gathering Hidden Gems on the History of Dregish and the People Together'.*** The second is a history of the ***Clergy of Adrstraw West*** by Brian Devenney, edited by Fr McCawille. Thank you to NLH Fund and Rapid for their support.

THANK YOU: Deborah Lowry offers her thanks to all who supported in any way the ***Team Hope Garden Tea Party*** at her home in September. She is most appreciative of the generosity shown by the entire community and is delighted to share that the event raised almost £5,000. The funds raised will support Team Hope's longer-term development work, helping vulnerable families and communities overseas to build more secure and hopeful futures.

TEAM HOPE CHRISTMAS SHOE-BOX APPEAL for children in Africa and Eastern Europe: You are invited to fill a wrapped shoebox with gifts using the 4Ws - something to Write, Wash, Wear and Wow, and include a €6 contribution towards transport and delivery. Shoeboxes can be dropped off between 1 and 10 Nov at Castle Coffee, or Urban Barn/Pet Store, both in Castlederg. For further details, labels and guidance, visit www.teamhope.ie. Thank you, from Deborah Lowry and all at Team Hope!

As our parishes prepare to welcome Fr Chris next weekend, Fr Thomas and I take this opportunity to wish him every blessing in his ministry in Aghyaran, Ardstraw West & Castlederg and Drumquin.

Born in 1986, Fr Chris is a native of Leckpatrick Parish. His parents, Rosemary and Sean, live in Strabane. Fr Chris tells us that his three brothers, two nieces and a nephew form his closest family. Following school, Chris was employed for several years in an administrative role at the Oncology Department of Altnagelvin Hospital. He subsequently pursued seminary studies at St Malachy's College, Belfast, and St Patrick's College, Maynooth. Since ordination in June 2016, Fr Chris has ministered among the faith communities of St Eugene's Cathedral in Derry, Drumragh (Omagh), Limavady, Kilrea & Desertoghill, Errigal (Garvagh) and Granaghan (Swatragh).

Fr Chris says that, after spending the last five years 'on the missions' in Co Derry, he now looks forward to serving the people of the West Tyrone Pastoral Area. He and Kobe (the pet dog) will take up residence in Castlederg Parochial House at the end of the month.

Fr Chris brings many gifts to his ministry and, in giving generously of himself to serving the people entrusted to his care, I know that he will enjoy the support and encouragement of you all. I pray God's blessing on all that you will share and accomplish together.

Please keep Fr Chris in your prayers as he prepares to move to Castlederg and begin the next chapter of his priestly ministry in the West Tyrone Pastoral Area.

May God bless you all,

Fr Paul.

St Joseph's Hall Mon 4.30 pm - Groogan O' Doherty School of Dancing.
Tues 2.30 - 4.30pm - Colmcille Club.
Tues 8.30pm – Bingo.
Wed 5.45 pm - Baxter School of Dancing
Thurs 8.00pm - Bowls.
Sat 2.00pm - Groogan O'Doherty School of Dancing
Booking forms and hall rates are available to download at
www.drumraghparish.com/st.joseph's hall

A WEEKEND LIKE NO OTHER
Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend
St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo Friday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027
This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday and is open to all married couples.
Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Library Lounge: A Beginner's Guide to Genealogy – find out how to get started on your family tree using free resources available in the library and online. Enjoy a cuppa, a chat and more! For people aged 60 plus to share, create, and connect.
Monday 26th October 11:00am – 1:00pm Booking Essential.

Marys Meals Coffee Morning Strathroy Community Centre
Sat 28th November 11am to1.30pm Contact Pauline 07922868753

Notice to Parishioners
Due to the discontinuation of the publishing programme previously used to produce our Parish Newsletter, we have had to introduce a new layout. We hope you will find the updated format clear and easy to read as you continue to keep up to date with parish news, and announcements.

Needing to talk badly about others indicates low self-esteem. That means, 'I feel so low that instead of picking myself up, I have to cut others down.' Letting go of negative things quickly is healthy.
Pope Francis

Parish Contacts

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org
Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055
malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org

Parish Office, 48 Brook Street, Omagh, County Tyrone, BT78 5HE
Office hours: Mondays, Tuesdays and Thursdays 9.00am-2.00pm
028 8224 2092 / info@drumraghparish.com

Parish of Drumragh
Sacred Heart Church, Omagh
St Mary's Church, Drumragh
25TH October 2026

Mass & Confession Times
Sacred Heart, Omagh 5.30pm *Saturday Vigil*, **10.00am & 12.30pm**
St. Mary's, Drumragh 10.30am
Mass schedule for the Cappagh Parish Churches
Christ the King, Strathroy 12noon
St Mary's Killyclogher 6.30pm* *Saturday Vigil* **9.00am, 11.15am**
* The vigil Mass at 6.30pm has been temporarily moved to Killyclogher owing to disruption caused by Roadworks at Strathroy/Gortin Road
Weekday Mass Times *unless otherwise announced*
Sacred Heart 10.00am *Mon-Sat* **7.30pm** *Wedneday*
Beginning next week, the evening Mass will be changed to Thursdays at 7.30pm

Confessions *unless otherwise announced*
Sacred Heart Saturdays after the 10.00am Mass
Christ the King Saturday 5.30pm – 6.20pm*
St Mary's Killyclogher Saturdays after the 10.00am Mass
**Confessions scheduled for Christ the King will be temporarily moved to St Mary's Killyclogher while the roadworks remain in place*
Times of Confessions liable to change in the event of a funeral
Eucharistic Adoration Wednesday after the 10.00am Mass until 6.45pm
NEXT WEEK THURSDAY after the 10.00am Mass until 6.45pm

FIRST HOLY COMMUNION ENROLMENT EVENING
Parents/Guardians who would like their child to receive the Sacraments must register with the parish. There will be an Enrolment Evening for First Holy Communion on Tuesday 10th November at 7pm in Sacred Heart Church, Omagh.
It is essential that parents/guardians attend, along with their child.

Mass Times for All Saints' & All Souls Day
Sunday 1st NOVEMBER Usual Sunday Mass times as above
Bishop Michael Router will celebrate the 12.30pm Mass next Sunday, during which Fr Paul Fraser will be inducted as the new Parish Priest of Drumragh
Monday 2nd November

St Mary's, Drumragh	**10.00am**	**St Mary's, Killyclogher**	**10.00am**
Sacred Heart	**7.30pm**	**Christ the King, Strathroy**	**7.30pm**

Mass Intentions (Sacred Heart Church)

Sunday 25th October 10.00am Frances & Eugene McNamee

Wednesday 28th October 7.30pm Ryan Gormley – Month Mind
Patsy McCrory - Anniversary

Sunday 1st November 10.00am Johanna Gallagher 4thAnniversary

Saturday 31st October 2.00pm **(Drumragh)** Rene Colton 1st Anniversary & Seamus Treanor 5th Anniversary

Sunday 1st November **(St. Mary's, Drumragh**) Charles Mulligan – Month Mind

Baptisms – We welcome into God's family: **Fiachra Fionn Carlin, Amy Louise Mimnagh,Turlough Mark Gillespe,Nancy Marie Wardle & Rosa May Wardle**

Deaths – We pray for Sean McCrory, Botera Road,

Vocations - St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group Day of Prayer and Healing - Speaker: Fr John Keane Theme 'People of God's' delight Saturday 15th November. Silverbirch Hotel, BT79 7DH. Registration 9.30am Holy Mass & Healing Service in afternoon. £40 includes coffee and lunch. Booking by Sunday 1st November (essential for catering purposes) Please include any dietary Requirements Contact Evelyn 07876 411435 Or Kathleen 07596 609041

ST PATRICK'S DUNGANNON CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP: GOLDEN JUBILEE Saturday 5th December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00am and concluding with Mass at 3.00pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Fr Peter McCawill will give a talk in the Pastoral Centre on **Thursday 29th October at 8pm** entitled " We are the Church". Let us rejoice that we are the chosen People before God.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

The Royal National institute of the Deaf are holding their bi monthly free drop in event in Omagh Methodist church hall on Thursday the 29th October from 10.30 till 12.30. Come along and have your hearing checked, new batteries provided and find out how to get the best from your aids.

The Columban Young Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation next Thursday 19 November, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend! For any further information please contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, Tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

On the 15th November at 2pm in St Anne's Cathedral, Belfast we will be hosting one of our **Saying Goodbye Services** and as this is the most local service to you this year we wanted to share this information with you.
So, who is the service for?
Anyone who has either personally lost a baby at any stage of pregnancy, at birth, or in early years, or who has been affected by family members' or friends' loss. Whether the loss was recent or 80 years ago, everyone is welcome to attend. We have also extended the services, and gladly welcome anyone who is grieving the fact that they haven't had children. This may be due to circumstance, infertility, or for other reasons - but all are welcome. Babies and children are also invited to come with their families, as the Saying Goodbye service is truly a family event for all. We know that as 1 in 4 women suffer miscarriage and baby loss, you will have contact with a significant number of people who have either personally suffered baby loss, or who have a partner or family member that has, so we wanted to ask if you would help us in promoting the service.
To read more on the charity, please see the Saying Goodbye website, which you can find at: www.sayinggoodbye.org

25th October 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1866
Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.
Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. **Email address**
dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org
Parish Website https://www.parishofdungiven.com

SUNDAY MASS TIMES

Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey
Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven
Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven
Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn
Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven

WEEKDAY MASS TIMES

St. Patrick's: Mon., Tues. & Wed. 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

For Yvonne O'Neill on Saturday 31st October at 6.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

The 9.00 am. Mass next Sunday 1st Nov. in St. Patrick's will be celebrated for all deceased members of the society.

CONFESSIONS: Will take place in St. Patrick's at 11.00 am. on Saturday.

THE ROSARY: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.

LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £2,871
Thank you to all who contributed.



BAPTISM - ***Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.***
Baptisms will take place in St. Patrick's Church *at 3.00 pm.* ***Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.*** **The Baptism Course**: Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course:** ***Wednesday 4th November at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.***

S.V.P. HELPLINE 079 2792 992

DEATHS - We extend our sympathy to the O'Neill family circle on the death of Kearin O'Neill, Mitchel Park. To the Hassan & McLaughlin family circle on the death of Josephine Hassan, Feeny. May they rest in peace.

PARISH REQUIEM

Requiem Mass will be celebrated in St. Patrick's Church, **on Mon. 2nd Nov. at 7.00 pm**. This Mass is in remembrance of all those who have died from November 2025. Everyone is welcome to come and pray for members of their families who have passed away in our Parish over the years.

LEGION OF MARY ROSARY FOR THE DECEASED

The Legion of Mary invites you to join us in the Emmaus Hall, on Mon. 26th Oct., for a Rosary offered for those who have died recently, our deceased family members, relatives and friends, the Holy Souls in Purgatory, those who have no one to pray for them and all the faithful departed. We will also remember those who grieve the loss of loved ones, asking for Our Lady's intercession to bring them comfort, strength and peace. **Everyone is welcome.**

TRAINING FOR MINISTERS OF HOLY COMMUNION

Fr. Sweeney will be conducting training in St. Patrick's Church on **Mon. 9th Nov. at 8.00 pm.** for all Ministers of Holy Communion and Ministers taking Holy Communion to the Sick**.** **It is very important that all ministers attend this training.**

MINISTERS OF HOLY COMMUNION FOR NOVEMBER

ST. PATRICK'S:
Saturday 6.00 pm.
Glenda McCloskey & James McClarey
Sunday 9.00 am.
Rory McGilligan & Nuala McAreavey
Sunday 11.30 am.
Celine McKenna & Martina McNicholl

.....

READERS FOR NOVEMBER
ST. PATRICK'S
Saturday 6.00 pm. – Maria McLaughlin
Sunday 9.00 am. – Geraldine Brolly
Sunday 11.30 am. – Cora O'Kane

VOCATIONS SOCIETY OF ST. JOSEPH

Are having a **Coffee Morning** on **Mon. 26th Oct.** in the Emmaus Hall, after the 10.00 am. Mass. All welcome. Donations welcome.

BIBLE STUDY – CHANGE OF TIME

Please note! Due to the Legion of Mary Rosary taking place in Emmaus Hall on Mon. 26th Oct., **Bible Study will begin one hour later than usual, at 8.00 pm. in the Blessed Sacrament Chapel.**
This is a one-off change to accommodate the Rosary during October, the Month of the Holy Rosary. New members are welcome!

VOCATIONS - St. Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love. There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sun. 8th Nov., beginning at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

KEEPING WELL IN WINTER

As the colder months approach, it's important to look after your health, wellbeing and home: Come along for a friendly afternoon with: - Health checks and wellbeing advice. Information to help you stay safe and warm at home. Advice and support from local services. An opportunity to meet organisations and find out what support is available locally.
Whether you want to get a quick health check, pick up some useful information, or simply have a chat and find out what support is available, you'll be very welcome. Dungiven Sports Centre, Wed. 28th October, from 2.00 – 4.00 pm. All is welcome and is FREE TO ATTEND

DUNGIVEN REGENERATION CLUB

Upcoming events: *Mindfulness 4 weeks starting Mon. 2nd Nov. 12 noon - 1.00 pm. *Art 6 weeks starting Thurs. 5th Nov. 7.00 - 9.00 pm. To register or for more information contact 07759692122

COVID AND FLU VACCINATION DROP-IN CLINIC FOR FEENY MEDICAL PRACTICE PATIENTS

Wed. 4th Nov. Dungiven Practice, Chapel Road. 10.00 am. – 5.45 pm. Patients are requested to walk or lift share to the venues if they can, as parking is limited and prioritised for those with limited mobility.

KEVIN LYNCH H. C.

Lotto no's: 3, 10, 13 & 23. Lucky dip: Agnes McElhinney. Jackpot: £2,400. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Wanes World*

GLENSHANE HOUSE

Names now being taken for L2 Autism course, 4 weeks x 3 hours on a Monday night. Cost is £30 registration + £18 exam fee. To register: Tel 028 777 42494.

WHIST DRIVE

St. Peter's Hall, Drumsurn today, Sun. 25th October at 7.30 pm.

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME PARISH OF ERRIGAL 25th OCTOBER 2026

Parish Website: www.errigalparish.com
Parish Facebook - Parish of Errigal
Email address: errigalparish@gmail.com
Parochial House Errigal: Tel: 29558251
Parochial House Kilrea: Tel: 29540343
Parish Emergency Number - (voicemail available) 07484823217
St. V dePaul - 07563595868 (voicemail available)
(Notices for newsletter received by 6pm on Wednesday to email address above)

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: Monday at 10am. Mission Schedule Follows
St. Joseph's Church: - Mission Schedule.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -
Anniversary Mass: For Josephine O'Kane on Sunday 25th October at 10am.
Anniversary Mass: For Eileen O'Kane on Sunday 1st November at 10am.
……
St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass:
Anniversary Mass:

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in October.
Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after morning Mass.
Annual November Mass for the Deceased of our Parish
St. Mary's Church - Saturday 7th November at 6pm.
St. Joseph's Church - Sunday 8th November at 11.30am.
Requiescant in Pace: We extend our sympathy to the family and relatives of Celine McGilligan, 55 Liscall Road who died recently.
Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.
Returns (Pink/Yellow - 91 White - 73)
St. Mary's - Parish: £485 Renovation: £145
St. Joseph's - Parish: £440 Renovation: £385
Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 15, 18, 27, 29. Jackpot is £4000. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Ciara & Ferghal Deighan.
Readers & Eucharistic Ministers
St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 31st October/1st November
Sunday Morning - Carol Ann McLaughlin.
Eucharistic Ministers - 31st October/1st November
Sunday Morning - Kate Mullan & Brian Mullan.

Errigal Parish Mission
Tuesday 27th October until Monday 2nd November.
We hope you will be able to join us for what promises to be a special week of prayer, reflection and renewal for our parish community.
'This is what the Lord asks of you: only this, to act justly, to love tenderly and to walk humbly with your God.' Micah 6:8
'Parish Mission Schedule'
EARLY MORNING MASS – AT 7am.
ST. MARY'S CHURCH – TUESDAY, THURSDAY AND MONDAY
ST. JOSEPH'S CHURCH – WEDNESDAY & FRIDAY
WEEKDAY MORNING MASS IN EACH CHURCH AT 10AM
Beginning Tuesday 27th October - including All Souls Day.
Each weekday evening the Service is at 7.30pm.
(Sermon, Rosary and Benediction will take place)
Also, each morning and evening the Sacrament of Reconciliation will be available.
TUESDAY - Opening evening in St. Joseph's Church
WEDNESDAY - Evening Service in St. Mary's Church
THURSDAY (evening) - St. Joseph's - Sacrament of the Sick & St. Martin Relics.
Those who are sick and housebound are encouraged to attend, if possible, can a family member transport them to the church.
FRIDAY - St. Mary's - Youth Evening. (Prayers led by Parish Youth)
SATURDAY - Mass - St. Mary's Church at 10am.
USUAL WEEKEND MASSES
SUNDAY (All Saints) - St. Mary's - Adoration Evening. (Blessing of Roses) - 6pm.
Monday (All Souls) - St. Joseph's - (Ceremony for the Deceased - evening at 7.30pm).
MONDAY (All Souls) - Morning Mass in St. Mary's Church at 7am.
10am Mass in both churches.
Evening - Close of Mission in St. Joseph's Church at 7.30pm.
Refreshments/social gathering -
Glenullin - Wednesday morning after 10am Mass in Community Hall.
Ballerin - Sunday after Devotions in the Errigal Hall.
Schools will participate in morning 10am Masses in each church on All Souls Day.

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 7th November in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 8th November at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 4th November at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Friday 30th October using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Errigal Youth Group: Parish Gift (Growing in Faith Together) - Grow closer to God, connect with friends, get involved in your community and discover your gifts! Saturdays directly after the Vigil Mass in October and November in Glenullin GAC (small hall) (October) Ballerin Errigal Hall (November). Registration available in QR code available in community apps.

Sacrament of Reconciliation: Sacrament of Reconciliation (Confession) available after the Vigil Mass on request.

Parish Envelopes: The new cycle of envelopes has now been distributed. Those who contribute to the parish by standing order or currently receive envelopes - Thank you for your generosity towards the parish! If you wish further information regarding setting up a Standing Order or the use of envelopes. Please contact using the parish email address (errigalparish@gmail.com), or telephone 29558251. (voicemail available)

St Anne's Conference of SVP: Are looking for volunteers for our Thrift Shop. If you would like to join our team, please phone 028 295 40103 to leave your name and telephone no and we will be in contact with you. Thank You.

Confirmation Candidates Gathering Dates: The autumn gathering of the Confirmation classes (P7's) from both local schools will take place on -

Tuesday 3rd November - (St. Mary's Church/Errigal Hall)

Tuesday 24th November (Provisional Date) - (Glenullin Community Centre).

Each evening from 7pm - 8.30pm. Parental consent forms will be required for those who gather it will be obtained via each school.

Mass Cards (pre-signed): Signed Mass cards for all occasions are available in the side porch of St. Mary's Church as requested by parishioners. A suggested donation of £5 is requested with the name of the recipient in a brown envelope included. Please put the brown envelope in the St.Vincent dePaul box, where it will be retrieved and the monies and Mass intention will be offered locally or by another priest.

Parish Safeguarding: Vetting process will take place on the first Saturday of every month **after** the Vigil Mass. This will be to re-vet all existing volunteers as a new requirement from the Diocese. If you are over 18 and volunteer as a Sacristan /Choir leader /Children's Liturgy helper or Baptism Group helper for the parish please attend a meeting, on Saturday 7th November in Ballerin Parochial house 6:45pm-7:45pm, at your convenience. Please bring 3 forms of ID with you to the meeting for verification purposes. These will be scanned for parish records.

NB: Most of the Youth ministry volunteers have been recently vetted and therefore do not need to attend.

Parish Finance: Upon requests for information to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com The forms are also available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

The Diocesan 'Net' Newspaper: You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper-copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Acknowledgment of Standing Orders: Several parishioners have set up Standing Orders; however, we do not know the identity of these parishioners. We request for the purposes of bank registration parishioners follow the guidelines offered on the parish website. We require an email stating 1. Name 2. Address - from those who recently have set-up a Standing Order.

Parish Finance: Upon requests for information to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com The forms are also available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Mission Prayer

God our Father,
We thank you for the many gifts you have given us through your Son, Jesus Christ.
During our Parish Mission, we ask your blessing upon our parish family.
Open our hearts and minds to hear your Word.
Help us to welcome one another with love.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean the church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in the sacristy.

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Children's Mass Sheet: Is available with the parish newsletter each weekend at the back of the church.

New Cycle of Parish Envelopes - Standing Orders: We are currently issuing a new cycle of parish envelopes. Parishioners who wish to support the parish by standing order may do so by weekly or monthly contributions, at their own discretion. Standing orders can be set up online through your bank or by submitting a completed mandate directly to your bank. Forms are available on the parish website or from the Parochial House. Please ensure the standing order is issued in your own name so it can be properly identified. Mandates may be cancelled at any time through your bank. Once activated, we would appreciate an email acknowledgement for parish records, including your address and telephone number. This helps ensure you are not issued with a box of envelopes. If your circumstances change and you wish to return to using envelopes, for further information please contact the parish email - errigalparish@gmail.com. or tel - 29558251.

New Cycle of Parish Envelopes: Standing Orders - Currently we are in the process of issuing the new parish envelopes in the coming weeks. If you are interested in supporting our parish through the medium of a standing order. The details are as follows - It is at your discretion if you wish to contribute to this account by weekly/monthly contributions. If you advance the standing order, it can be processed either on-line with your bank or alternatively take the completed mandate direct to your bank. (A Standing order form is available to download from the Parish Website or available from the Parochial House). We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. A mandate can be cancelled at any time with your bank.

May this be a time of deepening faith, healing and renewal for our whole parish community.
Bring comfort to those who are struggling, hope to those who are searching,
And joy to all who seek you.
Through the intercession of the Blessed Virgin Mary, St. Joseph, and St. Martin,
May the Holy Spirit guide us, unite us, and lead us ever closer to you.
We ask this through Christ our Lord. Amen.

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine 'Sharing Good News' that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive 'Sharing Good News', please register your email address on https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/

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Children's Mass Sheet: Is available with the parish newsletter each weekend at the back of the church.

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

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Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters'* - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at: https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray.

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and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

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Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders: (**Errigal Ballerin:** Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) Errigal Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c). (**Errigal Glenullin:** Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) (Errigal Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c). Please follow the guidelines offered on the parish website.

Parish Finance: Upon requests for information to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com The forms are also available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

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Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders: (**Errigal Ballerin:** Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) Errigal Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c). (**Errigal Glenullin:** Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) (Errigal Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c). Please follow the guidelines offered on the parish website.

Fahan Parish Newsletter

"November Remember" Pastoral Initiative

With the grim statistic of there having been 150 people killed on the country's roads so far this year (12 more than the same period last year) – 45 of these people aged under 25 and 30 aged over 65 (of the 29 pedestrians killed, 10 were over 65) – we need to redouble our efforts as road users to do what we can to make our roads safer, especially as we enter the darker and colder months.

To this end, while November is a time when we remember our dead, this year, in an attempt to acknowledge that the life and death of each of us has its influence on others, we would like as many people as possible to take on a pledge to use the roads with care in November. The details of that pledge are to be found on posters and our social media pages. Also, next weekend, people are asked to collect a prayer card for their car to be recited each day during the month and a bottle of holy water to be sprinkled on their car and kept there.

Chief Superintendent Goretti Sheridan will address the Cockhill Novena on Sunday 1 November and launch this initiative. There will be signage placed on the roads entering our two parishes to remind us of this. Please do your best to participate in this and support it.

Father Bradley

Acknowledgement of Thanks

The Burt bingo committee wishes to thank all who contributed to their Big Bingo. €400 was raised for parish funds. Look out for another one prior to Christmas.

Baptisms

We welcome into God's family the following children who were baptised:

Eddie Patrick Devlin, Annaslee, Burnfoot and
Sean Óg Mullan, Culmore, Derry

May God guide and protect our children always

Parish office Will close for the Bank Holiday and reopen on Tuesday 27th at 10am.

Adoration in St Mura's Parish Church on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome.

Altar Servers We are recruiting new altar servers so any pupil currently in 3rd Class or older, and who have made their First Holy Communion are welcome to apply. Forms are available from the schools.

Vocations Meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (048) 79386259.

Burt Bingo every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm.

Burt GAA Lotto 5-14-21-23-27 Catherine Mulligan Bridgend €50 Ava Smyth Derry €50

Burt GAA Development Draw Launch at An Grianan Hotel, Burt on Sunday 25th October at 8pm All Welcome.

Beginners Line Dancing Class at St Mary's Hall, Burt Thursdays 7:45pm-8:45pm.

St Vincent De Paul Current and new 3rd level students in need of financial assistance please contact St Mura's SVP on 0860549976 or any member. SVP may be able to help.

Marys Meals:If you have any old notes or coins that you wish to donate to Mary's Meals they can be dropped off to McKenna's Londis, Buncrana on Friday 30th October, between 9.30am - 5.30pm. Otherwise collection can be arranged by contacting Eilis Conneely on 087 7060457.

The Columban Youth Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation next Thursday 19 November, 7pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend! For further information contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura's Church and St Aengus' are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

Mission Sunday Collection
Burt €1570
Inch €325
Fahan €1065
Sincere Thanks

fahanparish@derrydiocese.org
www.fahanparish.com

25th October 2026
Thirtieth Sunday In Ordinary Time

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9360151
(Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)

Mass Schedule

St. Aengus' Burt
(churchservices.tv/burt)

Monday 26th October Mass at 10am
Friday 30th October Mass at 7pm
Paula McDermott Month Mind Mass

Saturday 31st October Mass at 6.30pm
John Porter Anniversary Mass

Sunday 1st November Mass at 10.15am
Billy Newman Anniversary Mass

Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch
Sunday 1st November Mass at 9am

St Mura's Church, Fahan
(churchservices.tv/fahan)

Wednesday 28th October Mass at 7pm
John Donaghey Anniversary Mass
Hugh McDermott Anniversary Mass

Friday 30th October Mass at 10am

Sunday 1st November Mass at 11:30am
John Paul Doherty Anniversary Mass

Chapel Of Ease, Fahan
Thursday 29th October Mass at 10am

All Saints Day

Normal Sunday Mass times

All Souls Day

9am Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch
10am St Aengus Church, Burt
7pm St Mura's Church, Fahan

Confessions will take place before all Masses.

Annual Mass for The Dead

The Celebration of Mass for our dead takes place on
Wednesday 18th November at 7pm in **St Mura's Church, Fahan**

Families who have been bereaved from November 2025 to October 2026 will be contacted in the next couple of weeks, but there will be an opportunity for families to bring forward a candle for anyone who has died.

Candles will be on sale on the night for €5. All welcome to attend.

Throwing Open The Doors to Christ Novena

This year's Novena begins today Sunday 25 October at 7pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill. For the nine Sundays before Christmas we will gather for one hour and the ceremony will comprise of the Rosary, a talk given by an invited speaker, the Novena prayer and petitions (which can be placed in a box at the door of the church), a Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and finishing with Benediction of the Most Blessed Sacrament. Once again, the theme of this year's Novena is "Throwing Open the Doors to Christ" – taken from the homily of Pope St John Paul II at the Opening Mass of his Pontificate on 22 October 1978. The first Guest speaker on the opening night will be Bishop Michael Router. All are very welcome. Please come along, bring your families and make the most of this opportunity for prayer as we approach the season of Christ's birth.

(The Holy Hour each Sunday evening in St Mary's Oratory will cease for the moment, resuming after Christmas.)

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 07491 02233

Parish of Granaghan

Rev. Christopher McDermott



Thirtieth Sunday

25th October 2026

www.granaghanparish.com
E-mail:
christophermcdermott@derrydiocese.org
Telephone: 028 7940 1236

Weekly Masses: Saturday 31st October Vigil at 4pm and Sunday 1st November at 11am

Weekday Masses

No Weekday Masses - Regular Schedule for **all** Masses returns on Saturday 31st October

Give Blood – Michael Davitt GAC, Swatragh
https://nibts.hscni.net/online-booking-for-blood-donation-appointments/
Monday 27th October – 12:30 to 19:30

Maghera Heritage Centre

Afternoon Tea Dance at **Walsh's Hotel**
Music by Kenny Paul, Thursday 29th October, 2-4pm

Coppersmithing Workshop
Sat 31st Oct, 11-2pm |

Watercolour painting class - coming in Nov.
See Facebook/Instagram page for more details.

ST PATRICK'S DUNGANNON CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP: GOLDEN JUBILEE event: Saturday 5 December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00am and concluding with Mass at 3.00pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group: Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing, celebrating 50 years: Sunday 15 November 2026 in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh: Registration 9.30am, concluding in the afternoon with Mass. Theme: People of God's Dlight (Ps £40, including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November, please, for catering purposes: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.

Last week's collections:
Weekly: £1518.60. Shrine: 493.35.
St. Anthony: £164.68. Foreign Missions: £942.00.

Rest in Peace
John McKeefry, Upperlands Road
Thoughts and Prayers

Slaughtneil Bingo
Saturday 24th October 8pm.
11-page book £10. Line £20, House £40. Flyover £50, House £100. Last line £50, House £200.

Parish of Errigal Mission
Parish of Errigal Mission, led by the Dominican Friars, will take place from Tuesday 27th October to Monday 2nd November. This special week of prayer, preaching, reflection and renewal offers an opportunity to deepen our faith and grow closer to Christ.

Safeguarding Notice: Should you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or vulnerable people within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or e-mail dlp@derrydiocese.org. PSNI Tel 101. Northern HSCT Gateway Services on 028 9442 4459. Emergency Social Work Services on: 0800 1979 995.

St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love. **Fr. Pat O'Hagan**

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, **Fr Pat O'Hagan,** at pgoh2111@gmail.com
or by calling (028) 79386259.

THE PARISHES OF GREENLOUGH and BELLAGHY/BALLYSCULLION
25 October 2026 - THE THIRTIETH SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

This week's diary:

Monday 26 – Bellaghy, Mass, 9.30am
Tuesday 27 – Greenlough, Mass, 9.30am; Rosary: 7.30pm
Wednesday 28 – Bellaghy, Mass, 9.30am
Thursday 29 – Greenlough, Adoration, 9.00am – 5.00pm
Friday 30 – Bellaghy, Adoration, 10.00am – 7.00pm (Rosary at 6.30pm). Mass: 7.00pm.

Saturday 31 October – Vigil of All Saints' Day:
Greenlough, Mass, 5.30pm (streamed to Bellaghy)

Sunday 1 November - All Saints' Day
Mass: Ballyscullion, 9.45am; Bellaghy, 11.00am (streamed to Greenlough).

Monday 2 November is All Souls' Day - Mass Times
Bellaghy, 9.30am; Greenlough, 7.30pm.

Tuesday 3 November – St Malachy's GAC: The annual Club Mass for deceased members will be celebrated in the pavilion at 7.30pm. Everyone welcome. Refreshments afterwards.

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the families and friends of **Kathleen Brennan, Lavey,** and **Mary Mawhinney, Ballyscullion Road,** who died recently.

Anniversaries 24/25 October: Margaret Doherty (1st anniversary) Raymond Craig (Anniversary Mass Fri 30 October, at 7pm), Fr. Liam Donnelly, Callum Dougan, Arthur O'Neill, Sarah Tohill, Elizabeth Hanson, Patrick Joseph McLaughlin, Eileen Devlin, Mary Anne McAtamney, Harry McAllen, Sean Larkin, Brendan Quigley, Patricia Henry, Kate O'Donnell, Margaret McGurk, Pat Joe O'Hagan, Annie Madden, Rosemary Madden, Maggie McKillen, Mary Clarke.

Anniversaries next weekend (31 October/1 November): Peggy McErlean (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Patrick McKenna, Michael McGlinchey, Peter McKenna, Peter Kealey, Connie Potter.

May they rest in peace.

The Annual Mass for our Deceased Parishioners and friends will be celebrated in St Mary's Church, Bellaghy, on Friday 6 November at 7pm. There will be an opportunity to light a candle in remembrance of parishioners who have died since last November. **There will be a Service of Prayer for the Deceased** members of our parish in St Oliver Plunkett Church, Clady, at 7pm on Fri 13 Nov.

All three Churches will have a Box available at the Altar in which you can put the names of those you wish to be remembered in our prayers during November, the month of the Holy Souls.

Greenlough: November: Church Cleaning Team: Kathy McErlean, Pauline McErlean, Martina Mackle, Christina Carey.

Counters: Declan Maguire, Pauline McAteer, Liam McAteer, Rosemarie McAllister

THE PARISHES OF GREENLOUGH and BELLAGHY/BALLYSCULLION
25 October 2026 - THE THIRTIETH SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

Parish Offices: **Bellaghy – info@bellaghyparish.com** Tel: (028)79386259; 07703444280 Open: Monday, Wednesday, Thursday: 9am – 3pm; Friday: 8am – 11am. Closed on Tuesdays. Website: **www.bellaghyparish.com** **St Vincent de Paul** – Tel: 07508549588.

Greenlough: greenloughparish@gmail.com Tel: **(028) 2582 1190**. The office is currently closed, but anniversaries or other notices may be sent in by email or telephone. **Deadline**: 10am on Wednesday.

Baptisms: Greenlough (at 4.15pm): 28 Nov; 19 Dec. **Bellaghy: (at 1.00pm):** 7 Nov; 5 Dec.

Céilí Class every Thursday, 8-9.30pm, in the Open Door Complex, Bellaghy. Everyone welcome.

Kids' Hallowe'en Disco (in aid of School Aid Romania 2027) for 3-12 year olds, in St John Bosco Community Hall, Ballynease, Thursday 29 October, 6.30-8.30pm. Adm: £3 per child.

Messenger Magazine: subscription of £26 for 2027 is now due, and may be returned to the sacristies or the Parish Office, Bellaghy. Please let us know of any changes.

Chair Yoga & Fitness 6 week course started Thursday 22 October 12.30pm at Moneyglass Gym. £30 for 6 weeks. Contact 07801032270 to book. **Winter Wellbeing Event :** Saturday 28 November

Walking Group: If anyone is interested in joining a daytime walking group or becoming a walking leader, please contact 07784805135.

A Weekend Like No Other - Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend: St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Fri 9 - Sun 11 April 2027 This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at **www.marriageencounter.ie**

7-day Pilgrimage to Fatima, 28 June 2027. £975 per person sharing (£875 if paid in full by 30 November 2026) to include flights from Belfast, full board, full religious programme. For further details, please contact Christina Lagan on 07803192621.

Vocations: St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was ***"…with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel…"*** We pray for the future priests of the diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Holy Spirit as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

There will be a gathering for men aged 18-40 interested in diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, 4-7.30pm. Anyone interested should contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan.

We hope to form a **Greenlough Youth Parish Pastoral Council,** beginning in January 2027. Anyone aged 16-30 who would like to be involved, please contact **Shea McPeake** (07706077991 or sheamcpeake7@outlook.com) or **Shauna Lynn** (07845602798 or shaunalynn448@gmail.com).

THE PARISHES OF GREENLOUGH and BELLAGHY/BALLYSCULLION
25 October 2026 - THE THIRTIETH SUNDAY OF THE YEAR

The next **Greenlough Parish Day of Prayer in the Movement of Continuous Prayer for Marriage and Family Life** will be Wednesday 29 October. In November we **Remember our Beloved Dead.**

Our Parish Pastoral Councils would like to promote **Devotion to the Real Presence of Jesus in the Blessed Sacrament,** building on the Adoration already taking place on Thursdays and Fridays. To that end we will welcome speakers from the Diocesan Adoration Committee to all our weekend Masses on 14/15 November.

Also, we hope to run a six-week programme on **The Eucharist** during Lent 2027. Lent will begin on Ash Wednesday, 10 February. Anyone who would like to be involved, please leave your name and contact detail at either parish office.

Indulgences for the Holy Souls

From 12noon on 1 November until midnight on 2 November, all who have confessed, received Holy Communion and prayed for the Pope's intentions (one Our Father and Hail Mary, or any other prayer of one's choice), can gain one plenary indulgence by visiting a church or oratory, and there reciting one Our Father and Apostles' Creed. This indulgence is applicable only to the souls of the departed. Confession may be made at any time within the week preceding or the week following 1 November. Holy Communion may be received on any day from 1 – 8 November. The faithful who visit a cemetery and pray for the dead may gain a plenary indulgence applicable only to the Holy Souls on the usual conditions, one per day from 1-8 November, under the same conditions.

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP meets on **Thursday at 6.00pm** in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

PILGRIMAGES TO MEDJUGORJE & LOURDES 2027 Deposits and Savings scheme available on Thursdays in Parochial House from 10.30am-12noon.beginning in October. contact Margaret 07732468511

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

GIFT AID We are about to claim our Gift Aid for the tax year ending April 2026. If you are a member of our Gift Aid Scheme and have stopped paying tax please get in touch with the parish office to let us know as soon as possible. If you pay tax and would like to join our Gift Aid Scheme please get in touch with the parish office. Thank you to all who have joined the Gift Aid Scheme

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026.



Sun 25th Oct 2026 Vol 44 No 43

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS - Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE
71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

LOVE GOD AND YOUR NEIGHBOUR *Matthew 22:34–40*

Jesus brings us to the heart of faith: love God with our whole being and love our neighbour as ourselves. These commandments belong together.

Our prayer should shape how we treat others, especially those who inconvenience us, misunderstand us or cannot repay our kindness.

To love God wholeheartedly is to bring him our fears, disappointments and weaknesses, trusting that we are loved even in our poverty. Loving our neighbour means seeking their good through patience, forgiveness and honesty.

And "as yourself" reminds us that we too are people God loves. Humility acknowledges our faults while allowing us to receive his mercy.

This Gospel invites us to ask: are our prayers, plans and activities helping us become more loving?

Lord, let me receive your love today, and let that love shape how I treat the next person I meet.

HOLY FAMILY PARISH DRAW

Our Parish Draw will begin in January 2027 to provide funds for the refurbishment and future capital needs of our Parish. We sincerely hope that the draw will be as successful. It will run from 1st January 2027 to 31st December 2027 and, if our target number of subscribers is met, the monthly prizes will continue to be £1,000, £500 and £250 for a monthly subscription of **£10 by standing order or cash payment of £120 for year**. Part payments for a ticket can be made to the parish over the next twelve weeks Tickets on sale and standing order forms available after Masses every weekend or at the parish office from next weekend

Registration for the Parish Draw by standing order or cash will be open from 1st November 2026 and close on the 10th January 2027. All standing order and cash payments need to be completed by 10th January for the first draw on **Saturday 30th Jan.** A subscriber to the Draw must be at least 18 years of age.

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Celestine Cleere, Friel Close who died during the week. May she rest in peace.

BAPTISM Our parish family welcomes: Grace Eve McCreadie Templemore Cres. Padraig McGreevy Spruce Meadows.

READERS FOR NOVEMBER

6.00pm Vigil Monica Barr / Trevor Hughes **9.30am** Jason Ogle

11am Martin Doherty **12.30** Louise McCloskey

EUCHARISTIC MINISTERS FOR NOVEMBER

VIGIL William McGeehan, Danny Kivelehan, Nipper Nicell
9.30am Ann Daly
11.00am Jacqueline McCarron, , Lynn Kelly
12.30pm Christine Bonner,

Eucharistic Ministers are asked to leave their details in sacristy so that they can be added to the watts app group.

NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP will begin on Tuesday at the 7.15pm Mass. Please place Petitions in the box at the front of the altar.

MASS for parishioners who have died during the past year will take place on Wednesday 4th November and Thursday 5th November at 7.15.

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Charlie King, Richard King, Billy Nelis, Andy McClea, Carol Scallion, Martin Davis. Frankie McFeely, Berna Stewart, Patrick Maguire

MISSION SUNDAY COLLECTION 18th October £2380.66 & €123.51 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £1085.45 & €37.74 Thank you for your generosity

There are envelopes at the back of the church which is a collection for the Missions also. Please take one and return it next week.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation Thursday 19 November, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend! For any further information please contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION COURSES January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking. The courses can be booked on the website www.accordni.com All of these courses are in person.

JAN 29th/30th FEB19th/20th MAR 19th/20th 2027.

CATHOLIC MARRIAGE ENCOUNTER WEEKEND St. Mary's, Knock, Co. MayoFriday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027 This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

ST PATRICK'S DUNGANNON CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP: GOLDEN JUBILEE event: Saturday 5 December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00am and concluding with Mass at 3.00pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Mission Sunday
18th October 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com
E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com
Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*
Telephone: 028 29540343

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

Monday, Thursday and Friday at 10am in Saint Anne's Oratory.

November Mass for our beloved dead on Friday 6th November at 7.30pm in Drumagarner.

In Remembrance of

Briege McKeefry, Daniel Quinn, Ryan Bradley, Aidan Loftus, Patrick O'Hagan, Francis Lynch and Dan McFaul.
whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Harvest Thanksgiving Service in Tamlaght O' Crilly, Church of Ireland, on Sunday 18th October at 7pm. All welcome.

Our parish family welcomes
Seán-Ciárán Deighan, Maeve Michelle McErlain, Miles Emmet McErlain, Liam Ryan McShane, James Charles Mc Shane and Conlan Patrick Fleming
who were baptised recently.



May they always walk as children of the light!

Last week's collection amounted to £1,905.
September Standing Orders £2,460.
Thank You

First Anniversary Mass for **Colm Mullin** on Saturday 08th November 10am in Drumagarner.

Slaughtneil Bingo

Saturday 24th October 8pm.
11-page book £10. Line £20, House £40. Flyover £50, House £100. Last line £50, House £200.

Vocations: "St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."..... Fr Pat O'Hagan

Kilrea GAC News
Lottery result 24th September: 2,9,15,16.
No Winner £4,200
£50 – Roisin Hanna
Next Jackpot is £4,250. Tickets on Klubfunder.

Safeguarding Notice: Should you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or vulnerable people within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or e-mail dlp@derrydiocese.org. PSNI Tel 101. Northern HSCT Gateway Services on 028 9442 4459. Emergency Social Work Services on: 0800 1979 995.

Readers for 24th Oct/25th Oct
7pm:
Sue Anne Mullan
10am:
Pauline Quigg
12noon:
Padraig Quigg

Eucharistic Adoration
Every Monday from 12noon until 7pm at ***Drumagarner.***
Concludes with public prayers.
New participants very welcome!!

INDULGENCES AT THE COMMEMORATION OF ALL SOULS



1. From **12 o'clock noon on 1st November until midnight on 2nd November,** all who have confessed, received Holy Communion and prayed for the Pope's intentions **(one Our Father and Hail Mary, or any other prayer of one's choice) can gain one Plenary Indulgence by visiting a church or oratory, and there reciting one Our Father and the Apostles' Creed.** This indulgence is applicable only to the souls of the departed. **Confession** may be made at any time within the week preceding or the week following 1st November. **Holy Communion** may be received on any day from **1st to 8th November**. **2.** The faithful who visit a cemetery and pray for the dead may gain a Plenary Indulgence applicable only to the Holy Souls on the usual conditions once per day from **1st to 8th November**. The conditions mentioned above apply also for this.

Thank you to everyone who visited and supported the sunflower field in Ballymacpeake this summer. We greatly appreciated your generosity, and we donated all funds raised to Macmillan Cancer Care.



Parish Office

Please have all Anniversaries names & News Items in **by WEDNESDAY.**

The Parish Office will be **CLOSED** this **Monday 26th October.**



Thank-You



Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458
E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org
Web: www.laveyparish.com

"You must love the Lord your God with all your heart; you must love your neighbour as yourself." Jesus gives us these two commandments as the only way to full human living and happiness. They are the core of Christian living and practice. We try everything else and yet love is all that human life is about here and hereafter. These two commandments go hand in hand as two parts of the one movement of life. Love of God is the ultimate in human life. It involves each of us in a personal relationship with God through prayer. Our Catholic tradition is very rich in the variety of prayer forms that are possible. Each of us needs to choose the ones that are helpful for ourselves. We reach this love of God also through our love for one another. In our common worship through the Sunday Eucharist we build up the People of God. And through love in marriage and family life we dedicate all that is good in life to God.



Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.

MASS SCHEDULE

Monday 26th October	**9.15 am Mass**
Anniversary Mass for Father Liam Donnelly	
Wednesday 28th October	**NO MASS**
Thursday 29th October	**9.15 am Mass**
Friday 30th October	**9.15 am Mass**

Adoration** will begin **after morning Mass** and conclude at **5.00 pm.

Feast of All Saints

Saturday 31st October	**5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
	6:00 pm Mass
Sunday 1st November	**9:00 am Mass**
	11:00 am Mass

*Father Graham will be on retreat from **Monday afternoon** until **Wednesday afternoon this week.***



Church Webcam - We have upgraded our church webcam this week. If you are having any issues accessing our webcam, please contact **Church Media** on **028 8773 8494** or email **info@churchmedia.tv.**



November Lists

Our November Deceased List are available at the back of the Church this weekend. When completed please return to the box at the front of the Church.



Parish Collections: 18th October

Weekly: **£922.02**
Building: **£1002.00**
Loose Coin: **£641.35**
Thank you for your continued support!



Sunday 25th October - 30th Sunday in Ordinary Time

MASS OF REMEMBRANCE

Our Annual Mass of Remembrance for those who have died or been buried in our parish during the past year will take place on **Wednesday 11th November at 7.00pm.**



The Cathedral of
ST. EUGENE

Cathedral Choir Director

St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel **(028) 7126 2302** or email: **recruitment@derrydiocese.org.**
Submit completed applications to **Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP**, or email them to **recruitment@derrydiocese.org.**
Applications must be received by **noon on Thursday 12th November 2026**. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer.

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group

Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing, celebrating 50 years: **Sunday 15th November 2026** in the **Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh:** *Registration 9.30am, concluding in the afternoon with Mass.* **Theme: People of God's Delight.** Speaker: **Fr John Keane.** Cost: **£40,** including lunch.
Book by 1st November, please, for catering purposes - **Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.**



Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time - Year A - 25th October 2026
Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com
Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com
Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:34-40)*

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognize the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 4th November at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio.

Remembering Our Deceased Loved Ones Special Remembrance Masses for those who have died from our parishes in the past year will be celebrated as follows:

Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane: Tuesday 3rd November at 7.00 pm

Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road: Thursday 5th November at 7.00 pm

St Patrick's Church, Murlog: Friday 6th November at 7.00 pm.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord and let perpetual light shine upon them.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of
Maureen McCrossan, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane;
Rosemary Donnell, Mount Bernard Rise, Castlederg;
Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries Sean Carlin, Margaret Daly, Thomas Daly, Margaret Devine, Jenny Doherty, John Doherty, Brad Doherty Snr, Ann Farry, Raymond Foley, Kathleen Gamble, Catherine Hannigan, Tony Hannigan, Stim Hughes, Patrick Kennedy, Paschal McCallion, Tommy McDaid, Edie McDermott, Alex McDonald, Kathleen McGill, George McGinley, Rose McGrath, Pam McLaughlin, Bridie McMenamin, Eileen Porter, Tony Stewart. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:
Leckpatrick £1,163.91 (£549 Missions)
Clonleigh €1,726.23 (€275.61 Missions)
Camus £1,645.97, (£636.33 Missions)
Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 1st November (All Saints):
1st Reading: Revelation 7:2-4, 9-14;
Psalm: 24:1-2, 3-4, 5-6;
2nd Reading: John 3:1-3;
Gospel: Matthew 5:1-12

Saints of the Coming Week:
Tuesday St Otteran, monk;
Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles;
Thursday St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop;
Friday St John of Capistrano, priest;
Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Please Note that from Monday 2nd November, weekday Mass at **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road** will be at **7.45 am**. We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at **St Patrick's, Murlog** is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notice. We thank you all for your co-operation and understanding.

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Day of Prayer, **Praise and Healing,** celebrating 50 years takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration: 9.30 am, concluding with Mass in the afternoon. Theme: People of God's Delight (Ps 194.4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. Cost £40 (includes coffee and lunch). Please contact Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041 by 1st November to book (for catering purposes).

Parish Draw The October parish draw for Camus / Leckpatrick takes place on Thursday 29th October at 7.30 pm in the parochial house, Ballymagorry. Please return outstanding payments to your promoter or to the parish office. Good luck.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd - 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

St Patrick's, Dungannon Charismatic Prayer Group: Golden Jubilee Event: Saturday 5th December, at the Servite Priory, Benburb, commencing at 11.00 am and concluding with Mass at 3.00 pm. Everyone is welcome to this 50th celebration, with theme "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come."

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "… with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 3rd November and 1st December from 8 - 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Diocesan Priesthood? There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood in Derry on Sunday 8th November at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th - 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com

The Columban Young Adults is a relatively new group for those aged 18 - 35 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on **Thursday 19th Nov at 7.00 pm** at Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. We are seeking new members. Please come along and bring a friend! For information, please contact columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend takes place in St Mary's, Knock, Co Mayo from Friday 9th - Sunday 11th April 2027. This residential weekend starts at 7.30 pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30 pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets on Wednesday 28th October from 12.30 pm - 1.30 pm at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00 pm, beginning this Sunday, 25th October. The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament. We encourage everybody, including those in particular need of healing to join us. Join us also via https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Job Opportunity St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry is recruiting an experienced Choir Director (10 hours per week) to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir, ensuring that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description / application pack, please contact (028) 71262302 / recruitment@derrydiocese.org Completed applications must be submitted to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP or to recruitment@derrydiocese.org by noon on Thursday 12th November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. Applications from men and women and from members of all communities welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Mondays at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm. Some fun, excitement and slight competition. Everyone welcome.

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Centre 2000, 21-27 Moyle Rd, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP on 30th Oct from 12.30 - 4 pm & 5 - 7 pm. Visit https://nibts.bookinglive.com/book/add/p/6 / tel 08085534653.

A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett from Fri 6th - Sun 8th November at Termonbacca, An opportunity for prayer, reflection and to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or Termonbacca Derry | Derry | Facebook

Gamblers Anon Tel 71351329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am
Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm
St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.00 pm**; Sunday: 9.45 am
St Mary's Cloughcor: Sunday 8.30am (25th Oct - alternate Sundays - 8th Nov)
St Joseph's Glenmornan: Sunday 8.30am (1st Nov - alternate Sundays – 15th Nov)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
Tuesday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).
10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
Thursday: **10.00 am**: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Friday: **8.00 am**: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.
Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.**
Office hours: Monday - Thursday 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday 9.30 am - 12.30 pm. Feel free to call in or phone on 028 71882215.
Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.
A Small Collection of Candles, Mass cards / Mass bouquets available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.
St Pio prayer cards also available.
A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash /cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995.

Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23.

Limavady Parish

25 October 2026

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

LITURGICAL PROGRAMME FOR WEEK COMMENCING Monday 26 October 2026

Monday 26 October - Friday 30 October	10.00am	Mass: Christ the King Church (streamed)
Thursday 29 October	1.00pm to 6.00pm	Eucharistic Adoration in St. Mary's Church.
Saturday 31 October	4.30pm	Vigil Mass: Christ the King Church (streamed)
	6.00pm	Vigil Mass: St Finlough's Church (streamed)
Sunday 1 November	9.00am	Mass: Christ the King Church.
	10.30am	Mass: St Mary's Church (streamed)
	12.00noon	Mass: Christ the King Church

Readings for next Sunday: Apoc 7:2-4, 9-14. Ps 23:1-6, R/ cf v 6. 1 Jn 3:1-3. Mt 5:1-12.

TELEPHONE NUMBERS:

PARISH OFFICE 028 777 62522
(MONDAY – THURSDAY:9.00 am -1.00 pm)

Msgr. McCanny 028 777 29759. **Fr Harkin** 028 777 63944

Email:parishoflimavady@btinternet.com. Website:www.limavadyparish.org

PARISH BULLETIN:

The bulletin is available online. Visit: www.limavadyparish.org

All notices should be emailed to parishoflimavady@btinternet.com or left in the post box outside the parish office before Wednesday at 1.00pm.

IN THESE DIFFICULT TIMES PLEASE REMEMBER THE SVP RED BOX. HELPLINE 075123603

ANNIVERSARIES:

Valerie Anderson, Mary Brolly, James Anderson, John McGee Senior, Des Keane, Ian Turner, Sarah Mullan, Margaret Mullan, Dermot McGilligan, Sean McAlorum, James Joseph McGrotty, Joe Cummings, Ken Mullan, Michael McAleer.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

The Month's Mind Mass for **Mary Johnston and Anniversary Mass for William Johnston** will be celebrated on **Saturday 31 October at 4.30pm in Christ the King Church**.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for **Neil Gibson** will be celebrated on **Sunday 1 November at 12.00 noon in Christ the King Church**.

ANNUAL MASS OF INTERCESSION FOR THE DEAD
will be celebrated on:
FRIDAY 6 NOVEMBER at 7.30pm
in CHRIST THE KING CHURCH

Please complete sheets with names of those you wish to be remembered at this Mass and throughout November.

Baptism

We welcome into God's family:

JACK JAMES BEATTIE

COBHLAITH MÉABH BRITT

REMEMBER!
Clocks go backwards one hour on Sunday 25th October.





PARISH DRAW: will take place on

MONDAY 26 OCTOBER.



Collection in Bethany from 6.30pm to 7.30pm. All welcome.

Readers for November:

Weekdays:	Weekends:
Monday: **Mary O'Hara**	Christ the King 4.30pm Vigil: **Cathy Mallon**
Tuesday: **Marion McCloskey**	St. Finlough's 6.00pm Vigil: **Patricia McIvor**
Wednesday: **Clare Dunne**	Christ the King 9.00am: **Mark Gannon**
Thursday: **McCrystal Family**	St. Mary's 10.30am: **Roe Valley Integrated**
Friday: **Geraldine Carlin**	Christ the King 12 noon: **Mary Lea**



FOYLE HOSPICE THANK YOU:

£1,705.00 raised as a result of Foyle Hospice Quiz Night.

Thank you to everyone who attended or contributed.



ST. FINLOUGH'S HALL BINGO

on **Friday 30 October**

at **8.00pm**

Last House: £500 to go!

CÉILÍ NEWS:

Céilí classes continue in the **Drummond Hotel**
Wednesday nights, 8pm to 9.30pm.
New members welcome.

OUR NEXT CÉILÍ IS ON SUNDAY 15TH NOVEMBER. ALL PROCEEDS TO ST. VINCENT DE PAUL PLEASE SUPPORT!



Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, tel (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Closing date: 12 November.

St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "... with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION COURSES

January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking.
The courses can be booked on the website at www.accordni.com
JANUARY 29TH/30TH 2027
FEBRUARY 19TH/20TH 2027
MARCH 19TH/20TH 2027.
E mail; derry@accordni.com. Web; www.accordni.com

PARISH OF ERRIGAL MISSION: The Parish of Errigal Mission, led by the Dominican Friars, will take place from Tuesday 27th October to Monday 2nd November.
This special week of prayer, preaching, reflection and renewal offers an opportunity to deepen our faith and grow closer to Christ.
All are warmly welcome, whether from the parish or neighbouring communities. We invite you to join us for as much of the Mission as possible and to keep its success in your prayers.
For more information, please visit https://www.errigalparish.com/

WEEKLY ENVELOPE COLLECTION: Weekly Collection: **£4,410**

Standing Order: If you wish to set up a Standing Order, please contact the parish office – Tel: (028) 777 62522.
Office open Monday to Thursday 9.00am to 1.00pm.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison
Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email:
Northern Ireland emergency services
PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101
Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker)
Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459
Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995

Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish
It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

CONFESSIONS – Daily after Morning Mass (except Sunday and Holydays) & St Mary's at 7pm on Wednesday (before Evening Mass) and Saturday 11am/12Noon & 5.30pm/6.15pm

St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning g their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction".

HOLY FACE OF JESUS: – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

OUR LADY UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA: - Continues in St Mary's Church on Wednesday evening 21 October after 7.30pm Mass.

DO THIS IN MEMORY – P4 preparation for First Holy Communion takes place at 11.30am Mass in St Mary's Church today (Sunday)

OCTOBER DEVOTIONS:
In St Mary's Church each Sunday evening at 6pm during October.

PARISH OF GREENLOUGH – will hold a Mass in St Oliver Plunkett Church, Clady, at 7.30pm on Friday 23 October to remember all those whose funerals were celebrated under Covid restrictions. Everyone is very welcome!

PIONEER TOTAL ABSTINENCE ASSOCIATION: Requests for PTAA pins currently processed per written application to Pastoral Centre Office.

MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID TRAINING COURSE - will take place on 27th & 28th Oct from 9.30am/4.30pm in Heaney Homeplace, 45 Main Street, Bellaghy. Please Note – to be eligible to apply you must live within or directly deliver a service within the Northern HSC Trust area. E-mail: denise@cwsan.org or phone 07540969623

ENVELOPE COLLECTION - Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,433.00. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded.
Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button.

ROSARY ON BENONE BEACH this Sunday 18th Oct at 3pm

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am.

GLEN GAA Website www.wattygrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 44:47:24:38: No winner. Next week £13,500. Three £50 winners. Cara Hampson, Suzanne Brock and Niall Kelly. --Flyover £16,800 in 45 Nos. or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

MAGHERA HERITAGE CENTRE – 'Maghera Memories & Itchy Feet' talk by John Burns on Tues 20 Oct at 7.30pm. Afternoon Tea Dance at Walsh's Hotel, music by Kenny Paul on Thurs 29 Oct from 2pm/4pm. Copper smithing Workshop on Sat 31 Oct, 11am/2pm. Watercolour painting class coming in Nov.
See Facebook/Instagram page for more details.

AN CARN - CHAIR AEROBICS - Thurs 22 Oct from 9.30am/10.30am at An Carn, £5.
Bilingual Comedy Night: Funny Focail – Half trí Ghaeilge agus half through English, providing a space to practice and learn cúpla focail, and most importantly to have a laugh with comedians Diane O'Connor, Louise O'Toole & Aideen McQueen! on Sat 24 Oct at 7.30pm. £10
Half-term break: Kids Animations, Workshop - Kids will use LEGO to create their own stop-motion animations, learning the basics of animating a short film and they'll also get to produce a live-action film using visual effects! on Tues 27 Oct from 10am/2pm. £15-8+

45-CARDS - re commence on Monday 26 Oct at 7.30pm

SLAUGHTNEIL GAC – BINGO – on Sat 24 Oct at 8pm. 11-Page Book - £10, Line £20. House £40, Flyover £50, House £100, Last Line £50, House £200.

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP – We will be delivering our first-ever Kids' Papier-mâché workshop during the Hallowe'en holidays on Tuesday 27 Oct from 1pm/3pm approximately. Our tutor will be Louie Winward. Louie is no stranger to Swatragh, but this will be her first time delivering a workshop for us. Open to boys and girls and geared towards 8–12-year-olds. Guaranteed to be messy but §marvellous. Parents welcome to stay too. Places allocated on a first come, first served basis. Phone: Anne McNicholl 07714757643
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DIOCESAN YOUTH CO ORDINATOR – 1 Year Fixed Term Contract with possible extension. 16 hours per week (including evening and weekend work) Place of Work: Gate Lodge, Catechetical Centre, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry. Salary: £12,688-£13,498 per annum .Applications must be returned to by Thurs 22 October. Tel. 7126 2302 or email:- recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Please remember to put your clocks back one hour next Saturday night

30th Sunday in Ordinary Time

25th October 2026

One Question, One Answer: Two Sides, Same Coin

Another week, another trap. Last Sunday they came with a coin. This week a lawyer comes with a question: which commandment is the greatest?

Jesus does not hesitate. Love the Lord your God with all your heart, all your soul, all your mind. Then, though nobody asked, he adds a second and says it is like the first: love your neighbour as yourself. On these two hang the whole Law and the Prophets.

Think back to that coin. Every coin has two sides, heads and tails, but nobody has ever spent one side of a coin. It is one piece of metal or it is nothing. That is what Jesus is saying about love. Love of God is one side. Love of neighbour is the other. Try to separate them and you are left holding something worthless. You cannot love the God you have never seen while ignoring the neighbour you see every day. And you cannot truly love the neighbour without the God whose image that neighbour bears.

That is the link. Last week Jesus asked whose image was on the coin. We said that we bear God's image. So does the stranger, the widow, the orphan, the man whose cloak is held in pledge. The first reading is blunt about it: give the cloak back by sunset, because it is all he has to sleep in. God's compassion lands in practical places, in coins and cloaks.

St Paul tells the Thessalonians that their faith is known everywhere. Not because of their preaching, but because people saw how they lived. Their faith had two sides, but it was never two-faced. Like the coin, it was solid and the same.

Loving God is what we do in Church. Loving neighbour is how the world knows we mean it. Two sides. Same coin. Spend it well.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2745.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1370.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 25 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary Rosary at the Mass Rock, Tulacorr Heights tomorrow Monday 26 October at 12 noon.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism

Darragh Frankie McCay

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Anthony Patton, 1 Hazel Gardens

Marie McNulty, 32 Millhaven

Lisa Kelly, 103 Beech Mount Village

Marie McNally, 61 Carrick Strand

Maureen McCrossan, 3 Innisfree Gardens

Rosemary Donnell, Castlederg

Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries

Seamus McLaughlin, Kieran Doherty, Pam McLaughlin

Noel McCrory, Patsy Kennedy, Martin McElwee

Deirdre Conway, Kitty McLaughlin, Kathleen Moss

George McGinley, Pat Nugent, Damien McClay

Charlie Flanagan, Maybid Doherty, Edie McDermott

Mamie McNulty, Noreen Doherty, Derek Fletcher

Mary McLaughlin, Gregory Forbes, Philomen Murray

William McLaughlin, Tony Gillespie, Charlie Neeson

Billie Hamilton

Vocations St. Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was *'…with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel…'* We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Baptism Dates Melmount

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14, 21 & 28.

December: Saturday 12; Sunday 20.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Volunteers are Required one morning per month to help with Eucharistic Adoration for St. Mary's P.S. children as part of the Children of the Eucharist (COTE) programme. Safeguarding requirements apply. If you would like to get involved, please leave your contact details with the Parish Office.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for November to the Parish Office on **Monday 16 November from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for November will take place on Thursday 19 November at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane (DLP) on 07596500793/

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Or

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Forty Hours St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.

Sunday 8 November 2026

8.00am *Morning Prayer*

11.30am *Mass*

3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*

6.00pm *Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer and Stations of the Cross*

9.00pm *Rosary*

9.30pm *Night Prayer*

Monday 9 November 2026

12.00am *Rosary*

3.00am *Rosary*

6.00am *Angelus and Chaplet*

8.00am *Morning Prayer & Rosary*

10.00am *Mass*

12.00pm *Angelus and Midday Prayer*

3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*

6.00pm *Angelus and Chaplet*

8.00pm *Holy Hour: with Evening Prayer and Rosary*

9.30pm *Night Prayer*

12.00am *Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours*

If You Are Willing To Volunteer To Help Cover An Hour Or Hours During The 40hrs, Please Let Us Know What You Will Do By Filling Out A Commitment Card Found At The Back Of The Church Or Online And Posting In The Box At The Sacristy Or Into Fr Sean, The Parish Office Or By Email. It Would Be Good To Get All The Hours Well Covered To Maintain A Continuous Presence Of People With The Lord, And To Be There For The Holy Hour On Sunday And Monday Evenings.

Sion Mills Group of Alcohol Anonymous will hold a public information meeting on Wednesday 28 October at 8.30pm in Sion Mills Community Centre. Everyone welcome.

Derry & Strabane PCSP – *Staying Safe, Staying Independent* A day of FREE road safety and scam awareness for the over 65's. Monday 26 October at 10.00am in the Bog Hall, Sion Mills. Everyone welcome.

The Parish Draw for October took place on Thursday 22 October. The winners are as follows:

£500: 1204 Karen McMahon – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£250: 1105 Paul Coulter – *Declan Duffy*

£250: 1957 Christine Gallagher – *Deirdre Martin*

£250: 1136 Jim Gallagher – *Ann Donaghey*

£150: 1324 Sandra O'Doherty – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1030 Brian Tracey – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 2007 Noel & Delia Devine – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1038 Angela & John Quinn – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1361 Nora Kennedy – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1518 Alice Houston – *Katrina Houston*

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove







Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 25th The greatest and first commandment; you must love you the Lord our God with all your heart, soul and mind. The second resembles it: you must love your neighbour as yourself.

Tuesday 27th St Otteran, is usually identified with Odhran who preceded Columba to Iona. His death is recorded in 548 and his grave was greatly revered in Iona. He was chosen by the Vikings as patron of Waterford in 1096 and later patron of the diocese.

Wednesday 28th St Simon and St Jude, apostles. Nothing is known of Simon except that he was born in Cana and was called the Zealot. Jude, also known as Thaddeus, was the apostle who asked the Lord at the Last Supper why he showed himself only to his disciples and not to the world.

Thursday 29th St Colman, bishop. From Kilmacduagh, Co Clare. Founded two churches in Aran, on Inis Mhór, before returning to Kilmacduagh to make a further foundation there.

Saturday 31st Blessed Dominic Collins (1566-1602) was born in Youghal, Co. Cork. After a military career he joined the Jesuits as a Brother. He was captured in 1602 by the English who tried to make him abjure his faith. He was martyred in Youghal on 31 October 1602.

Sunday 1st November All Saints We celebrate the great company of all those who have gone before us and now enjoy the beatific vision, sharing in God's life in the glory of heaven. **11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballybrack. Reader** at this Mass will be Miriam Turnball

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am.

Confessions in St. Pius X Church**:** Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm.

The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Robert Carey, Carrowbeg, who died recently. May they rest in peace.

Baptism: We welcome into God's Family **Lila Helen McDermott,** Dublin, **Callan Patrick McColgan**, Edinburgh and **Eada May Cavanagh,** Bredagh Glen who were baptised recently.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €2862.

Prayer for Vocations: St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "...with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel..." We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love. We pray to the Lord. "It is to the glory of my Father that you should bear much fruit and then you will be my disciples." Are you being called to love the Lord and His people as a priest, sister or brother? Anyone interested in serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry should contact the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP Bellaghy and Greenlough, at 0487938 6259 or at pgoh2111@gmail.com

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

Serenity House (9382945) serenityhouse@eircom.net Chiropodist on Friday 30 October. Linocut Card Making and Calligraphy course begins Wednesday 4 November. Serenity House is a drop off point for the Inishowen **Christmas Shoebox Appeal** again this year. All boxes must be in Serenity House by Monday 9 November.

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) Places are available on several courses including Creative writing, Woodcraft, Christmas decorations and Kid's Halloween craft. Dance this evening at 8pm. Admission €5.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie Thanks to all who donated to our church gate collection last week. Balance with Bronagh Halloween Special on Saturday 31 October at 11am. Call 00447827057701; Christmas Wreath Workshop on Thursday 26 November at 7pm. Contact Hayley 00447947431574; Christmas Craft Fair on Saturday 21 November from 12 noon to 3pm Tables €20; Citizens Advice drop-in every Wednesday from 9.30am – 4.30pm; Beekeeping for Beginners (6-week course) from Saturday 7 November at 11am.

S**t Eugene's Hall** (0864519812/0838132948 email steugeneshallmoville@gmail.com) Movie Night Wednesday 28 October at 7pm. Under 12, €2 per child; Spooky Disco on Thursday 29 October at 6.30pm Fancy dress prizes. Under 12, €3 or €10 for family of four. On both nights child must be accompanied by an adult.

St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced **choir director** to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. For a job description and application pack, call 04871262302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

If you'd like to receive a copy of the **parish newsletter** by email, please send an email to: movillebulletin@gmail.com The newsletter will be sent out securely, giving no one else access to your email address, in accordance with GDPR.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

30th Sunday in Ordinary Time
25th October 2026

One Question, One Answer: Two Sides, Same Coin

Another week, another trap. Last Sunday they came with a coin. This week a lawyer comes with a question: which commandment is the greatest?

Jesus does not hesitate. Love the Lord your God with all your heart, all your soul, all your mind. Then, though nobody asked, he adds a second and says it is like the first: love your neighbour as yourself. On these two hang the whole Law and the Prophets.

Think back to that coin. Every coin has two sides, heads and tails, but nobody has ever spent one side of a coin. It is one piece of metal or it is nothing. That is what Jesus is saying about love. Love of God is one side. Love of neighbour is the other. Try to separate them and you are left holding something worthless. You cannot love the God you have never seen while ignoring the neighbour you see every day. And you cannot truly love the neighbour without the God whose image that neighbour bears.

That is the link. Last week Jesus asked whose image was on the coin. We said that we bear God's image. So does the stranger, the widow, the orphan, the man whose cloak is held in pledge. The first reading is blunt about it: give the cloak back by sunset, because it is all he has to sleep in. God's compassion lands in practical places, in coins and cloaks.

St Paul tells the Thessalonians that their faith is known everywhere. Not because of their preaching, but because people saw how they lived. Their faith had two sides, but it was never two-faced. Like the coin, it was solid and the same.

Loving God is what we do in Church. Loving neighbour is how the world knows we mean it. Two sides. Same coin. Spend it well.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2745.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1370.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 25 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary Rosary at the Mass Rock, Tulacorr Heights tomorrow Monday 26 October at 12 noon.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism
Darragh Frankie McCay

May they Rest in Peace
Deaths
Anthony Patton, 1 Hazel Gardens
Marie McNulty, 32 Millhaven
Lisa Kelly, 103 Beech Mount Village
Marie McNally, 61 Carrick Strand
Maureen McCrossan, 3 Innisfree Gardens
Rosemary Donnell, Castlederg
Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries
Seamus McLaughlin, Kieran Doherty, Pam McLaughlin
Noel McCrory, Patsy Kennedy, Martin McElwee
Deirdre Conway, Kitty McLaughlin, Kathleen Moss
George McGinley, Pat Nugent, Damien McClay
Charlie Flanagan, Maybid Doherty, Edie McDermott
Mamie McNulty, Noreen Doherty, Derek Fletcher
Mary McLaughlin, Gregory Forbes, Philomen Murray
William McLaughlin, Tony Gillespie, Charlie Neeson
Billie Hamilton

Vocations St. Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was *'…with the joy of the Holy Spirit that [they] took to the Gospel…'* We pray for the future priests of our diocese that they will feel the joy that comes from the Spirit of God as they read, live, and preach the Good News of God's love.

Baptism Dates Melmount
November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14, 21 & 28.
December: Saturday 12; Sunday 20.
Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Volunteers are Required one morning per month to help with Eucharistic Adoration for St. Mary's P.S. children as part of the Children of the Eucharist (COTE) programme. Safeguarding requirements apply. If you would like to get involved, please leave your contact details with the Parish Office.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for November to the Parish Office on **Monday 16 November from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for November will take place on Thursday 19 November at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane (DLP) on 07596500793/dlp@derrydiocese.org

Forty Hours St. Mary's Church, Melmount Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.

Sunday 8 November 2026
8.00am *Morning Prayer*
11.30am *Mass*
3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*
6.00pm *Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer and Stations of the Cross*
9.00pm *Rosary*
9.30pm *Night Prayer*

Monday 9 November 2026
12.00am *Rosary*
3.00am *Rosary*
6.00am *Angelus and Chaplet*
8.00am *Morning Prayer & Rosary*

10.00am *Mass*
12.00pm *Angelus and Midday Prayer*
3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*
6.00pm *Angelus and Chaplet*
8.00pm *Holy Hour: with Evening Prayer and Rosary*
9.30pm *Night Prayer*
12.00am *Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours*

If you are willing to volunteer to help cover an hour or hours during the 40hrs, please let us know what you will do by filling out a Commitment Card found at the back of the church or online and posting in the Box at the sacristy or into Fr Sean, the Parish Office or by email. It would be good to get all the hours well covered to maintain a continuous presence of people with the Lord, and to be there for the Holy Hour on Sunday and Monday evenings.

Sion Mills Group of Alcohol Anonymous will hold a public information meeting on Wednesday 28 October at 8.30pm in Sion Mills Community Centre. Everyone welcome.

Derry & Strabane PCSP – *Staying Safe, Staying Independent* A day of FREE road safety and scam awareness for the over 65's. Monday 26 October at 10.00am in the Bog Hall, Sion Mills. Everyone welcome.

The Parish Draw for October took place on Thursday 22 October. The winners are as follows:
£500: 1204 Karen McMahon – *Carol-ann Stewart*
£250: 1105 Paul Coulter – *Declan Duffy*
£250: 1957 Christine Gallagher – *Deirdre Martin*
£250: 1136 Jim Gallagher – *Ann Donaghey*
£150: 1324 Sandra O'Doherty – *Carol-ann Stewart*
£150: 1030 Brian Tracey – *Elizabeth O'Hare*
£150: 2007 Noel & Delia Devine – *Sheelagh McKelvey*
£100: 1038 Angela & John Quinn – *Elizabeth O'Hare*
£100: 1361 Nora Kennedy – *Sheelagh McKelvey*
£100: 1518 Alice Houston – *Katrina Houston*

CATHOLICIRELAND.NET
CAITLICIGH AR AN NGRÉASÁN

Click here to view Daily Readings from CatholicIreland.net

Click here to view Sunday Readings from CatholicIreland.net

Site Links

1. Latest News
2. Remembering our Dead.
3. WEBCAM
4. Prayers For Protection
5. Mass Times
6. Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 21: 15-21

In today's Gospel Jesus tells us to "repay to Caesar what belongs to Caesar and to God what belongs to God." His words invite us to reflect on our priorities, our responsibilities and the place God holds in our lives. While we have duties to our families, communities and society, our relationship with God must always remain at the centre.

Giving to God what belongs to God means more than attending Mass or saying our prayers. It means living our faith through love, kindness, forgiveness and compassion. When we care for the vulnerable, support those in need and reach out to the lonely, we make God's love visible through our actions.

In the busyness of everyday life, we can sometimes forget to make time for God. Today's Gospel reminds us that our possessions and achievements should never take his place in our hearts. What matters most is how we use our gifts and blessings to serve God and others.

As we reflect on today's Gospel, let us ask ourselves: Am I putting God first? Am I using my gifts for the good of others? Do my words and actions reflect the love of Christ?

May we have the courage to put God first, the generosity to serve others and the humility to recognise his presence in everyone we meet.

Lord, help us to give you what truly belongs to you: our hearts, our lives and our love. Guide us to serve others with kindness and generosity, and may everything we say and do bring glory to your holy name. Amen.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."

Mission Sunday 2026 – One in Christ, United in Mission. Mission Sunday, celebrated today, Sunday 18th October 2026, invites us to renew our commitment to sharing the Good News of Jesus Christ with people throughout the world. It is a special opportunity to pray for missionaries and the communities they serve, and to support their work through our generosity. Across the world, missionaries bring hope, comfort and practical help to those in need, often in challenging circumstances.

As a parish community, we are reminded that mission begins with each of us. Through our prayers, kindness and willingness to serve others, we can make Christ's love visible in our homes, our parish and the wider world. May this Mission Sunday inspire us to be joyful witnesses to the Gospel, sharing God's love with everyone we meet.

The St Dymphna Mass with Anointing of the Sick will be celebrated at St Eugene's Cathedral on Tuesday 20th October at 7.30pm. This Mass is to give thanks to God for positive mental health and to pray for those who are struggling with mental health issues and those who care for them.

Our Lady, Untier of Knots Novena - The Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots continues after the 7.30pm Mass on Thursdays, in St Eugene's Cathedral, concluding on Thursday 26th November. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care - learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:

Margaret McGilloway
Seamus Quigg

May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Christine Curran
Jack Knight
Margaret Knight

May they rest in peace

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Sarah Kennedy & Ryan Hegarty

who celebrated the Sacrament of Marriage recently in the Cathedral

May God bless you abundantly in love, joy and happiness

Sick Visitation

Fr Paul Farren will attend the sick and housebound in his care on Monday and Wednesday.

Collection

Weekly Collection:	£5,562
Parish Development:	£1,183

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

Mary's Meals: £100, £60
Smile Train: £100, £50, £20, €10
Sight Savers: £50
Somalia Appeal: £40
Rosemount Primary School: £500
Legion of Mary (Derry): £500
Hungry Children: £50, £50

Readers for 24th /25th October

6.15pm	Helen Sweeney
7.30pm	Niamh Kehoe
9.30am	Rosemary Finan
11.00am	McGinley Readers
12.30pm	Kevin Finan
7.00pm	Marian Boyle

Parish Pilgrimage to Rome, Loreto, Cascia & Assisi, Italy – 24-31 May 2027 – Fr Paul Farren will lead a Parish Pilgrimage to Rome, Loreto, Cascia & Assisi, Italy from 24-31 May 2027. Price is £1,550 per person sharing with a single room supplement of £245 (subject to availability). For more information please contact Anne Marie Hickey, Pastoral Co-ordinator on amhickey@derrydiocese.org or phone the Parish Office on 028 71262894.

Would you like to become an Altar Server in St Eugene's Cathedral? We are recruiting for anyone who is in Primary 5 and upwards, to come and serve at our weekend Masses. If you are interested in becoming an altar server, please email Lauren at lauren.doherty@derrydiocese.org or phone the parish office on 02871 262894 for more information.'

Called to Serve: A Day of Support and Inspiration for Parish Ministry on Saturday 21st November from 10am to 3.00pm in Knock Shrine. Are you involved in ministry in your parish, or interested in becoming more involved? Join us at Knock Shrine for a day of encouragement, learning, and sharing.
Whether you are a Minister of the Eucharist, Minister of the Word, Sacristan, in your parish choir, interested in developing a Sensory Mass, or looking for ways to engage young people more actively in parish life, this day is for you.
Come together with others involved in parish ministry to gain practical ideas, share experiences, and maybe be a little inspired! For more information visit https://www.knockshrine.ie/upcoming-events/

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Courses January 2027 to March 2027 are now online for booking. The courses can be booked on the website www.accordni.com. All of these courses are in person.

Struggling to understand how Direct Payments work? Looking for more information on how they could support you or someone you care for? Join us for a free information session delivered by The Centre for Independent Living, where you'll learn more about Direct Payments, how to access them, and the benefits they can provide.
The session will be held on 22nd October at 12 noon in Health for Life HLC, Central Drive, Creggan, BT48 9QG. To book your place or find out more, contact Eilish Brown at eilish.brown@healthforlifenw.org

Book of Memories of Father Paddy O'Kane. A new book is being planned about well-known Derry priest Father Paddy O'Kane, who died in 2022. Due for publication next year, it will include memories and stories from those who knew him, alongside selections from his *Derry News* column. If you have a memory or story to share, author Ciaran O'Neill would be delighted to hear from you. Email: caoneill1971@gmail.com Phone: 07875 904354

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org
Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

Vol 54 No 41
Twenty-ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time
18th October 2026

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

Sunday 18th October
Sunday 11th October
Sunday 4th October
Sunday 27th September
Sunday 20th September
Sunday 13th September
Sunday 6th September
Sunday 30th August
Sunday 23rd August
Sunday 16th August
Sunday 9th August
Sunday 2nd August
Sunday 26th July
Sunday 19th July
Sunday 12th July
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Saint Mary's Creggan

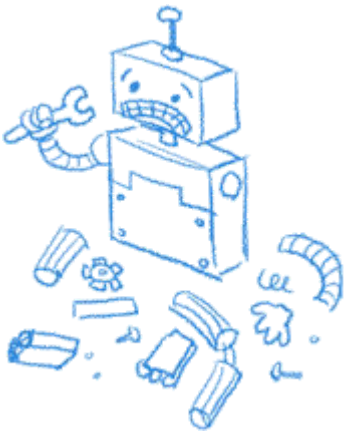
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STEELSTOWN PARISH

Parish Newsletter

THIRTIETH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME • 25 OCTOBER 2026 • YEAR A

Gospel Reflection | Matthew 22:34–40

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that the greatest commandment is to love God wholeheartedly and to love our neighbour as ourselves. These two responsibilities are inseparable and form the foundation of Christian life.

Loving God involves more than religious practices such as prayer, worship, and Scripture reading. It means trusting Him in difficult times, remaining faithful through challenges, choosing what is right, and allowing Him to guide every aspect of our lives. Genuine love for God is shown not only in words but also in daily actions.

Our love for God becomes visible in how we treat others. We cannot truly love God while harming, judging, or refusing to forgive those around us. Instead, we are called to show compassion, kindness, patience, and mercy. Even simple acts such as listening, encouraging, forgiving, and helping those in need can become powerful expressions of God's love.

Jesus also calls us to recognise the dignity and worth of every person, including those who differ from us or disappoint us. True love does not ignore wrongdoing, but it speaks the truth with respect and sets boundaries without hatred.

The central message of this Gospel is that love must be at the heart of both our relationship with God and our relationship with others. Faith is not measured by religious knowledge or activities alone, but by whether it transforms us into more loving people. When love guides our thoughts, words, and actions, our lives become a living witness to God's presence in the world.

Prayer for the Week • May the Lord bless us with hearts open to love. May He help us to see Christ in one another and to bring kindness, hope, and compassion wherever we go.

Sunday Readings | 1 November – All Saints

First Reading: Revelation 7:2–4, 9–14 • Psalm: 24:1–2, 3–4, 5–6
Second Reading: 1 John 3:1–3 • Gospel: Matthew 5:1–12

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: St Otteran, monk • Wednesday: St Simon and St Jude, Apostles
Thursday: St Colman of Kilmacduagh, bishop • Friday: St John of Capistrano, priest
Saturday: St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

Prayer, Worship & Vocations

Pray for Vocations St Paul reminds the Thessalonians that it was "with the joy of the Holy Spirit" that they took to the Gospel. We pray for future priests of our diocese, that they will experience the joy of the Spirit as they read, live and preach the Good News of God's love.

Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours Tuesday 3 November and 1 December, 8–9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Considering a Vocation to the Priesthood? Meeting in Derry on Sunday 8 November at 4 pm. Contact Fr Pat O'Hagan, Diocesan Vocations Director: pgoh2111@gmail.com or (028) 7938 6259.

Praying for the Holy Souls Our Lady of Montligeon Prayer Group meets Wednesday 28 October, 12.30–1.30 pm, at Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Annual Solemn Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help Nine Sundays before Christmas at Long Tower Church, Derry, 6 pm, beginning Sunday 25 October. Theme: "Make Me a Channel of Your Peace – Celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis." Each night includes the Rosary, Novena prayers and petitions, a guest talk, Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and Benediction. All welcome, especially those in need of healing. Webcam: https://longtowerchurch.org/webcam/

Parish & Diocesan Events

6–8 NOV	**A Weekend Retreat with Sr Clare Crockett** Termonbacca, Derry. Prayer, reflection and an opportunity to learn more about Sr Clare. Contact: termonbaccderry@ocd.ie or facebook.com/TermonbaccaDerry/
15 NOV	**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group – Golden Jubilee** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing at Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh. Registration 9.30 am; concluding with afternoon Mass. Theme: "People of God's Delight" (Ps 149:4). Speaker: Fr John Keane. £40 including coffee and lunch. Book by 1 November: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.
19 NOV	**The Columban Young Adults – Holy Hour & Meditation** 7 pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. For ages 18–35. Meditation by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by Solemn Benediction and refreshments. New members welcome. Contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.
20–22 NOV	**Abide Women's Conference** Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and the Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. Registration: Abide in His Love on Eventbrite.ie.
5 DEC	**St Patrick's, Dungannon – Charismatic Prayer Group Golden Jubilee** Servite Priory, Benburb, 11 am–3 pm, concluding with Mass. Theme: "Come to the water: all who are thirsty, Come." Everyone welcome.

Marriage & Family Life

ACCORD Derry – Marriage Preparation Courses In-person at the Everglades Hotel, Derry. Dates: 29–30 January, 19–20 February and 19–20 March 2027. Book at www.accordni.com.

Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo, Friday 9–Sunday 11 April 2027. Residential weekend for married couples, beginning Friday at 7.30 pm and ending Sunday at 4.30 pm. Online booking only: www.marriageencounter.ie.

Job Opportunity

Choir Director – St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry Experienced Choir Director sought for 10 hours per week to lead the cathedral choir and enhance worship through music. Application pack: (028) 7126 2302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, or by email, by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer; applications from all communities welcome.

STEELSTOWN PARISH • Growing together in faith, hope and love.



PARISH NEWSLETTER

T: 028 7126 2360 E: threepatrons@derrydiocese.org W: threepatrons.org

Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 25th October 2026 – Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this Sunday's Gospel, Jesus gives us the two great commandments: love God and love our neighbour. But there are two words we can easily overlook: *"Love your neighbour as yourself."* Jesus does not tell us to put ourselves first, but neither does he tell us that we do not matter. Christian love means learning to see ourselves as God sees us, with honesty, patience and mercy. We all have faults, regrets and things we would change, but none of these takes away our dignity or God's love for us. Perhaps learning to accept God's mercy for ourselves also helps us to become more merciful towards others. We do not have to demand perfection from ourselves, and neither should we demand it from those around us. Speak to yourself with the same kindness you would offer to somebody you love. You too carry the image of God.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY
Eoghan David O'Carroll; Grace Anna McCauley; Myles Eamon Doherty.

REQUIESCANT IN PACE
We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of: Michael Deery, Galliagh Park; Mary McIvor, Carnhill; Adrian Gallagher, Thorndale; Martin Concannon, Richmond Crescent; John Duffy, Kingsfort Crescent; Gerard Davis, Grainan Drive; Kevin Harkin Rossnagalliagh; Colm McGuinness, Fernabbey Drive

ANNIVERSARIES
Helen Hume; Andrew Deeney; Pat Mullan; Niall Walsh; Pat Nolan; Oran Manus McBrearty; Michael McCafferty; Ann McFaul; James McFaul; Georgie Campbell; Pauline McDaid; Una Collins; Fr Jim Hamilton; Tony McDaid; Michelle McGinley; James McGeady; Sadie Hasson; Liam Glenn; Hugh Doherty.

COME JOIN US FOR CHILDREN'S LITURGY
St Brigid's Church, Carnhill - 5pm; St Patrick's Church, Pennyburn - 9.45am; St Brigid's Church, Carnhill - 10.30am St Joseph's Church, Galliagh - 11am and 6.30pm. Children in P1-4 are invited to attend, where they will take part in an activity themed on Sunday's Gospel.

REFRESH & RENEW MORNING
For all existing and new Readers and Eucharistic Ministers in our Parish Churches, led By Sr Perpetua McNulty from 10am-12 noon on Saturday 21st November in St Joseph's Church, Galliagh. There is a sign-up sheet in the Sacristy.

THREE PATRONS MONTHLY CASH PRIZE DRAW
November: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; Top Prize £1,000. December: 5 x £100; 1 x £500; JUMBO PRIZE £2,000. Tickets cost £20. Monthly promoter prize of £50 for each winning ticket. Tickets are available from Church sacristies and Parish Offices. Card payments available at the Pennyburn Parish Office. Draws take place Friday, 20th November & Friday 18th December.

NOVEMBER MASSES FOR THE DEAD
Offered for parishioners who have died over the past year and their families. Wednesday 4th November at 7pm in St Joseph's Church, Galliagh; Wednesday 4th November at 7pm in St Patrick's Church, Pennyburn and Thursday 5th November at 7pm in St Brigid's Church, Carnhill.

DO THIS IN MEMORY MASS- WEEKEND
Saturday 7th November at 5pm, St Brigid's - Greenhaw PS
Sunday 8th November at 9.45am, St Patrick's - St Patrick's PS
Sunday 8th November at 10.30am, St Brigid's - St Brigid's PS
Sunday 8th November at 11am, St Joseph's Church – St Paul's PS & St Therese's PS

ANNUAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF PERPETUAL HELP
The Novena begins on Tuesday 27th October at 7pm, in St Joseph's Church, Galliagh and concludes on Tuesday 22nd December with a Penitential Service and confessions for Christmas.

FAMILY PRAYER BOOK
This Sunday begins psalter week 2.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION
St Patrick's Church: £1,143 - St Brigid's Church: £2,180 - St Joseph's Church: £1,010
2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,010.
Thank you for your continued generosity.
BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons
Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

LECTIO DIVINA ON SUNDAY'S GOSPEL
Take some time to pray, reflect and share as we explore the Gospel for the coming Sunday. Every Monday after the 10am Mass in the Emmaus Room, Pennyburn.

CELEBRATING 50 YEARS AT ST JOSEPH'S
11am Mass on Tuesday in St Joseph's will be offered for all those associated with St Joseph's for the past 50 years. There will be a cup of tea in St Pio House after Mass. All welcome.

PARISH COFFEE MORNING
We raised over £300 for the Foyle Hospice. Big thank you to all who contributed the delicious tray bakes and to all those who came along and supported the coffee morning.

VOCATIONS
There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, at 4pm. Contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com / Tel: (028) 79386259.

JOB VACANCY: ST EUGENE'S CATHEDRAL
An experienced Choir Director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. 10 hours per week: For details: Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Closing date: Thursday 12 November at 12noon. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer.

CYRPUS PILGRIMAGE – MAY 2027
16-24 May '27. Ex Belfast. A few seats have become available. Contact the Parish Office for more details.

CONSIDER TAKING THE SHORT-TERM PLEDGE
If you would like to make this pledge to give up alcohol for the intention of the Holy Souls this November, please contact one of our Parish Offices from 9am - 1pm to receive a temporary pioneer pin or visit www.pioneerassociation.ie.

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS
Is a group for those aged 18 - 35, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Next event: Thursday 19 November, 7pm, Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown. For more information contact us at columbanyoungadults@gmail.com.

CARE OF CREATION
'Each of the various creatures reflects in its own way a ray of God's infinite wisdom and goodness. We must therefore respect the particular goodness of every creature so as to avoid a disordered use of things.' (Catechism of the Catholic Church)

SAFEGUARDING
If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

ANNUAL SOLEMN NOVENA
In honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, at 6pm, starting this Sunday 25th.

MASS AND EVENING OF WORSHIP
Friday 13th November at 7pm in St Joseph's Church. Worshipping God with our hearts and our souls. Drawing down God's grace and power in our nation. Main Celebrant Fr Bernard Murphy CFR and talk by Patrick McChrystal. All welcome.

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS

Monday	After 10am Mass	Lectio Divina	Emmaus Room, Pennyburn
	After 11am Mass	Holy Souls Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	1pm – 2.30pm	Legion of Mary	Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh
	7pm – 8.30pm	Carnhill Folk Group	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7pm - 9pm	Woman's Craft Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass	Devotion to the Holy Face	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	12pm – 1pm	Reflection on Sunday Scriptures	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
	5.00pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Junior Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	7.30pm - 9.30pm	Living Disciples Prayer Group	St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm	St. Pio's Café	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	4.45pm – 5.30pm	St Brigid's Youth Choir	St Brigid's Church, Carnhill
	6pm – 7pm	Divine Will Prayer Group	Kildare Room, Carnhill
	7pm – 8pm	Holy Hour for the Unborn	Our Lady's Chapel
	7.30pm - 8.30pm	Youth Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh
	8.15pm – 10pm	Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh
Saturday	12noon – 1pm	The God Club	Kildare Room, Carnhill

PARISH SCHEDULE

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am; Wednesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Wednesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Wednesday: 10.30am – 4pm in the Emmaus Room
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Thursday: 7pm; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Thursday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm *(An tAifreann Naofa)*; 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am; Tuesday: 7pm
Confessions:	Tuesday: 6.15pm – 6.45pm; Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 7.00pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 25th October 2026

Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Commandment of Love

Love is the greatest of the commandments, the mother of all the virtues, and the pulsating heart of the Christian message. We are created in the image of a God who is Love; so, we cannot live without love

In today's gospel reading from Matthew, one of the Pharisees, a lawyer, asks Jesus to identify 'the greatest commandment of the Law' (Mt 22:36). In response, Jesus quotes the great 'shema' prayer recited daily by all devout Jews (cf. Deut 6:4-5). This prayer exhorts us to love God with our whole heart, mind and soul. Jesus immediately adds a second commandment, familiar to his audience namely, 'love your neighbour as yourself' (Mt 22:39).

Sadly, the word 'love' is so overused in our world today that it has lost much of its meaning. We speak of love of country, love of sport, love of food, love between friends, love of parents, romantic love, etc

As Pope Leo teaches, 'True love is not merely a fleeting, briefly inflamed emotion. It is more. It is a deep commitment to the other, a decision, a journey and a covenant for life

All genuine love is manifested in action; it is practical and outgoing. In the words of St Augustine: 'It has the hands to help others. It has the feet to hasten to the poor and needy. It has the eyes to see misery and want. It has the ears to hear the sighs and sorrows of people.'

Such love is demanding. It summons us to leave our comfort zones, to give our time, our energy, our talents, and, indeed, our very selves to others

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FEAST OF ALL SAINTS

Mass Arrangements for the Feast of All Saints- Saturday 31st October

6:00pm	**Church of Immaculate Conception**
6:00pm	**St. Oliver Plunkett**
6:30pm	**St. Columb's Church (note change of time)**

Diocesan Appointments - *This weekend is Fr Lagan's last weekend in our parish as our priest, I take the opportunity to thank him sincerely for his work both in the parish and the hospitals over the past four years. His endearing personality enabled him to get to know many people in a short period of time. His good humour and generosity of time have brought many blessings to many people and our parish community.*

As he begins a new phase of his life as Parish Priest in the Sperrin parishes of Gortin and Greencastle, I on behalf of the parish, wish him every blessing. It will be a very big change for him so let's keep him and all the priests involved in the latest diocesan appointments in our prayers.

Words of thanks from Fr Lagan

On 18th August 2022, Bishop Donal McKeown appointed me to the parishes of Glendermott and Strathfoyle. On that occasion, even though it was a change, I very much knew that I was coming home. I was sent to a parish that I had previously served and for a short while after my Ordination in 2012 began ministering as a Priest. It is a place that I love very much and this last four years have been both a time of immense blessing. On 9th October, Bishop Router appointed me to the parishes of Greencastle and Gortin in Co Tyrone. Whilst I am deeply honoured for his trust in me, I leave here with the best preparation I could ask for in taking up this new challenge. I want to thank all the staff of our parish, those who work to support the running of Glendermott and Strathfoyle, but especially to Fr Joshi for his kindness, guidance, support and friendship and to Fr Michael Canny for his ever willing example, paternal guidance and endless patience not only during my time here but throughout my Priestly Ministry and also to each of you, for your prayers, your faith filled example and for the love and kindness that you have shown me, I will forever treasure. Please keep me in your prayers and be assured of my prayers for you, your loved ones and families in the months and years ahead. Thank you.

Baptisms – We welcome into God's family: **Noah Doherty** Birch Hill, **Cailean John Christopher Tracey** Deramore Drive.

Anniversaries – For those whose anniversaries occur around this time Molly Hegarty, Nora Brown, Margaret Flynn, Jim Mellon, Fonsy Doherty, Bob Kelly, Joseph Devine, William Barr, Willie Guthrie, Paul McFadden, John Monaghan, Charlie Mullan, William McConomy, Bill and Kathleen Monk, Mary Storey, Brian Simpson, Lawerence Boyle.

Offertory Collections: **Glendermott: £3,800.00 Strathfoyle: £580.00**
Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections and Mission Collection taken up last weekend

Vocations- there will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible Many of us want to read the Bible but can find it difficult to understand. The Parish will be running 'Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible', an eight-part course that will help us to understand the main story of the Bible and how all the different parts fit together. It gives the 'big picture' and helps us see what the Bible is really about. We will meet on Monday evenings starting on 2nd November at 8pm (after 7.30pm Mass) in the Parish Hall, St Columb's Church. Sessions will begin with prayer, followed by a video presentation and small group discussion. By the end, you'll feel more confident reading the Bible and have a better understanding of how you fit into God's plan. To register for the course, please leave your name and contact details at the Parish Office (028 71 342303 or email secretary@watersideparish.net).

Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October. ***The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'***. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament.

Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, Tel. (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer

Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group: Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing, celebrating 50 years: Sunday 15th November 2026 in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh: Registration 9:30am, concluding in the afternoon with Mass. Theme: People of God's Delight (Ps 194.4). Speaker Fr. John Keane. Cost £40, including coffee and lunch. Book by 1ST November, please, for catering purposes: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**10.15am & 12.15pm**
St Oliver Plunkett Church	**11.15am**
St Mary's Oratory	**9.15am**

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am & 7.30pm**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**9.15am**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**11.00am Mon. Tues. Thurs.**
St Mary's Oratory	**11.00am – Wednesday only**

Saturday

St Columb's Church	**10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)**

Confessions

St Columb's Church	**Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm** **Saturday after 10.00 Mass**
Church of Immaculate Conception	**Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm**
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	**Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm**

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303
Email: secretary@watersideparish.net Web: www.watersideparish.net
YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net
Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersidepaish.net
Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.